

COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

RBI, Monetary Policy and Liquidity Management - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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RBI, Monetary Policy and Liquidity Management - Learner-v2

Complete Learning Session

Authoring-only generation: 2026-09-03. No PDF was rendered and no tracker or index was mutated.

SOURCE, PROGRESSION AND CURRENT-LINKAGE AUDIT

- **Generation date:** 2026-09-03.
- **Repository-first evidence:** the Basic owner is taught first and preserved in full; the Advanced owner is retained only in the optional final teaching block.
- **OCR evidence:** Repository Markdown was primary. OCR-searchable local official General Studies papers were used only to confirm printed routed demands. No answer key, marking scheme, unsupported page precision or current macroeconomic statistic was inferred from them.
- **Qdrant:** not used; repository Markdown and available OCR context were sufficient.
- **PYQ integrity:** This Basic owner carries audited objective routes on legal tender, rupee management, payment-data storage, the money multiplier, expansionary instruments, RBI status, lender of last resort, interest-rate hikes, sterilisation, RBI income and reform committees. No routed Mains demand is manufactured and no unavailable or provisional objective answer is inferred.
- **Live-link boundary:** The RBI Monetary Policy page was reachable only as raw HTML in this run. No current repo rate, stance, reserve ratio, liquidity amount or meeting outcome was extracted; the package relies on the audited owners for stable instrument mechanics and preserves every counterparty and legal distinction.
- **Fact/inference discipline:** no current-affairs item, PYQ wording, figure or quotation is invented.

LIVE OFFICIAL-SOURCE ATTEMPT LOG

The checks below were made on 2026-09-03. Substantive official text is used only for the proposition it actually supports; binary files, dynamic shells, stubs and undated dashboard snippets are recorded but not converted into current claims.

- <https://www.rbi.org.in/Scripts/Annualpolicy.aspx> - attempted 2026-09-03; the official page returned raw HTML identifying the RBI Monetary Policy page but no safely extracted current resolution, rate or stance, so no live policy number was used.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

DEEP-REVIEW LEARNING CONTRACT

Control	Binding rule for this package
Syllabus boundary	Complete Economy Basic/Core is answer-complete before optional Advanced depth.
Formula boundary	Formula, numerator, denominator, unit, stock/flow, nominal/real, base year, level/rate and accounting identity are explicit.
Institutional boundary	Constitution, statute, delegated rule, regulator mandate, policy, recommendation, scheme and implementation outcome remain distinct.
Transmission method	Shock or instrument -> prices/quantities/balance sheets/incentives -> institution and market response -> output, employment, distribution, stability and external effect -> lag and trade-off.
Current-data method	Source -> release date -> reference period -> unit/denominator -> provisional/revised/final status; incompatible Budget, Survey or statistical vintages are never mixed.
Programme-status method	Announced -> approved -> notified/guidelines issued -> funded -> operational -> utilised -> output -> outcome are separate stages.
External/WTO method	Agreement text, member category, box, limit, notification, consultation, dispute and ruling are qualified without invented thresholds.
Causal method	Accounting identity, chronology and correlation are not promoted into behavioural or causal claims without mechanism, counterfactual and alternatives.
Answer balance	Model answers balance growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal dimensions with India-centric evidence.
Practice contract	Every solved item has demand decoding, a detailed examiner-grade model, executable timed/compression plan, marks rationale and answer-specific improvement.
Approval	This immutable successor remains approved: false pending explicit approval.

Canonical Basic/Core owner:

upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Economy\basic\04_RBI-Monetary-Policy-and-Liquidity-Management.md

Substantive canonical provenance owner: upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Economy\04_RBI-Monetary-Policy-and-Liquidity-Management_Learner-V2-Complete-Topic-Package.md

Optional Advanced owner: upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Economy\advanced\04_RBI-Monetary-Policy-and-Liquidity-Management.md

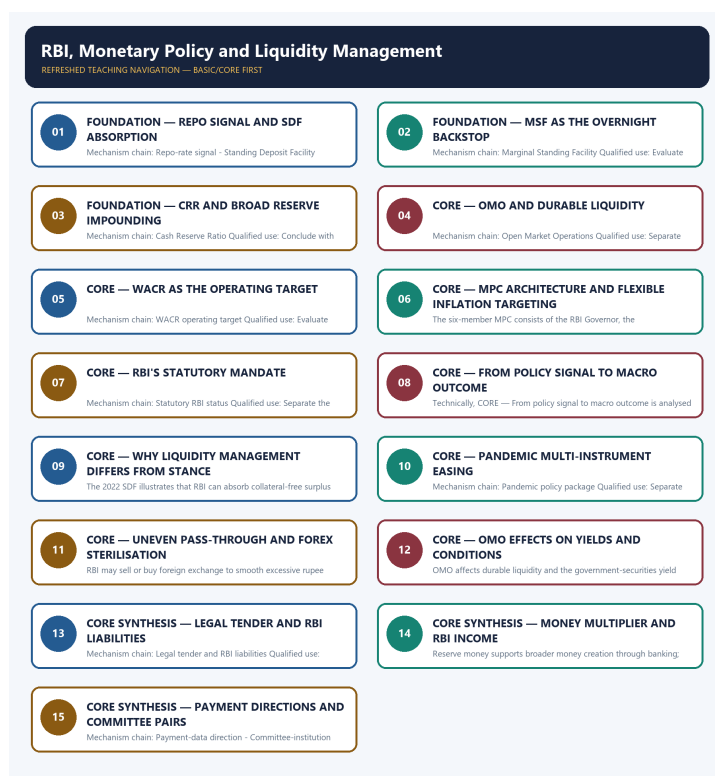
Official syllabus mapping: upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Economy\OFFICIAL-UPSC-SYLLABUS-MAPPING.md

EVIDENCE, PYQ AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROL

- Every data-heavy table states unit, denominator, geography, reference period and source/status.
- GDP/GVA, gross/net, domestic/national, nominal/real and level/rate distinctions remain exact.
- Monetary, fiscal and external chains state intermediaries, balance-sheet channels, lags, leakages and trade-offs.
- Budget and Economic Survey editions are never mixed; BE, RE, Actual, advance/provisional/revised/final estimates remain labelled.
- Scheme and programme claims distinguish announcement, approval, notification, operation, coverage, utilisation and measured outcome.
- WTO boxes, limits, de minimis, special treatment, notifications and disputes are qualified from authoritative rules.
- PYQ wording is preserved only where verified; reconstructed or routed demands remain labelled.
- **Current-status note, rechecked 2026-09-06:** volatile rates, estimates, scheme status, trade rules and institutional claims retain official source, release date, reference period and revision status.

Generation-local live/current sources:

- <https://www.rbi.org.in/Scripts/Annualpolicy.aspx> - attempted 2026-09-03; the official page returned raw HTML identifying the RBI Monetary Policy page but no safely extracted current resolution, rate or stance, so no live policy number was used.



Refreshed teaching navigation

Distinct embedded teaching-navigation image. The separate continuous Cārvāka-style flowchart package remains an independent at-a-glance artifact.

SESSION 1 - FOUNDATION - Repo signal and SDF absorption

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Repo signal and SDF absorption explains how Repo-rate signal and Standing Deposit Facility fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, Repo signal and SDF absorption separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Repo signal and SDF absorption must be read through Repo-rate signal and Standing Deposit Facility, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Repo
- signal
- absorption
- Repo-rate
- Standing
- Deposit

How to use them: Define Repo, signal, absorption; attach Repo-rate to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not equate every liquidity injection with a repo-rate cut.

VISUAL FIRST

REPO SIGNAL AND SDF ABSORPTION

01. Repo-rate signal

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02. Standing Deposit Facility

BOUNDARY -> Do not equate every liquidity injection with a repo-rate cut.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection. The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection.
- The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not equate every liquidity injection with a repo-rate cut.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Separate the repo signal from liquidity implementation and then trace pass-through.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Repo-rate signal -> Standing Deposit Facility
- **Qualified use:** Separate the repo signal from liquidity implementation and then trace pass-through.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Repo signal absorption Repo-rate Standing Deposit	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Repo-rate signal and Standing Deposit Facility through accounting, incentives and transmission	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Separate the repo signal from liquidity implementation and then trace pass-through.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not equate every liquidity injection with a repo-rate cut.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Repo signal and SDF absorption converts a precise economic distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 2 - FOUNDATION - MSF as the overnight backstop

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: MSF as the overnight backstop explains how Marginal Standing Facility fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, MSF as the overnight backstop separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

MSF as the overnight backstop must be read through Marginal Standing Facility, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- overnight
- backstop
- Marginal
- Standing
- Facility
- borrowing

How to use them: Define overnight, backstop, Marginal; attach Standing to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not treat OMO and repo as identical; one is outright and the other is a repurchase transaction.

VISUAL FIRST

MSF AS THE OVERNIGHT BACKSTOP

01. Marginal Standing Facility

BOUNDARY -> Do not treat OMO and repo as identical; one is outright and the other is a repurchase transaction.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

MSF is an overnight backstop borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities; its counterparty and emergency role differ from ordinary repo operations.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- MSF is an overnight backstop borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities; its counterparty and emergency role differ from ordinary repo operations.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not treat OMO and repo as identical; one is outright and the other is a repurchase transaction.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Evaluate monetary effectiveness by inflation source, banking health, fiscal conditions and external pressure.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Marginal Standing Facility
- **Qualified use:** Evaluate monetary effectiveness by inflation source, banking health, fiscal conditions and external pressure.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS overnight backstop Marginal Standing Facility borrowing	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Marginal Standing Facility through accounting, incentives and transmission	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Evaluate monetary effectiveness by inflation source, banking health, fiscal conditions and external pressure.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not treat OMO and repo as identical; one is outright and the other is a repurchase transaction.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MSF as the overnight backstop converts a precise economic distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 3 - FOUNDATION - CRR and broad reserve impounding

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: CRR and broad reserve impounding explains how Cash Reserve Ratio fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, CRR and broad reserve impounding separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

CRR and broad reserve impounding must be read through Cash Reserve Ratio, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- broad
- reserve
- impounding
- Cash
- Ratio
- share

How to use them: Define broad, reserve, impounding; attach Cash to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not assume ordinary NBFCs have routine LAF access like scheduled banks.

VISUAL FIRST

CRR AND BROAD RESERVE IMPOUNDING

01. Cash Reserve Ratio

BOUNDARY -> Do not assume ordinary NBFCs have routine LAF access like scheduled banks.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

CRR is the share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI, broadly impounding bank resources and affecting lendable funds.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- CRR is the share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI, broadly impounding bank resources and affecting lendable funds.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not assume ordinary NBFCs have routine LAF access like scheduled banks.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Conclude with credible communication, flexible operations and realistic limits on rate policy.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Cash Reserve Ratio
- **Qualified use:** Conclude with credible communication, flexible operations and realistic limits on rate policy.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS broad reserve impounding Cash Ratio share	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Cash Reserve Ratio through accounting, incentives and transmission	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Conclude with credible communication, flexible operations and realistic limits on rate policy.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not assume ordinary NBFCs have routine LAF access like scheduled banks.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CRR and broad reserve impounding converts a precise economic distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 4 - CORE - OMO and durable liquidity

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: OMO and durable liquidity explains how Open Market Operations fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, OMO and durable liquidity separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

OMO and durable liquidity must be read through Open Market Operations, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- durable
- liquidity
- Open
- Market
- Operations
- purchases

How to use them: Define durable, liquidity, Open; attach Market to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not call currency notes RBI income; notes issued are liabilities.

VISUAL FIRST

OMO AND DURABLE LIQUIDITY

01. Open Market Operations

BOUNDARY -> Do not call currency notes RBI income; notes issued are liabilities.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not call currency notes RBI income; notes issued are liabilities.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Separate the repo signal from liquidity implementation and then trace pass-through.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Open Market Operations
- **Qualified use:** Separate the repo signal from liquidity implementation and then trace pass-through.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS durable liquidity Open Market Operations purchases	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Open Market Operations through accounting, incentives and transmission	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Separate the repo signal from liquidity implementation and then trace pass-through.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not call currency notes RBI income; notes issued are liabilities.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: OMO and durable liquidity converts a precise economic distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 5 - CORE - WACR as the operating target

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: WACR as the operating target explains how WACR operating target fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, WACR as the operating target separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

WACR as the operating target must be read through WACR operating target, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **WACR**
- **operating**
- **target**
- **weighted**
- **average**
- **call**

How to use them: Define WACR, operating, target; attach weighted to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not assume a lower repo guarantees equal lending-rate reductions.

VISUAL FIRST

WACR AS THE OPERATING TARGET

01. WACR operating target

BOUNDARY -> Do not assume a lower repo guarantees equal lending-rate reductions.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The weighted average call rate is the operating target that RBI liquidity operations seek to align with the policy corridor; the policy target, repo rate and operating target are distinct.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The weighted average call rate is the operating target that RBI liquidity operations seek to align with the policy corridor; the policy target, repo rate and operating target are distinct.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not assume a lower repo guarantees equal lending-rate reductions.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Evaluate monetary effectiveness by inflation source, banking health, fiscal conditions and external pressure.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** WACR operating target
- **Qualified use:** Evaluate monetary effectiveness by inflation source, banking health, fiscal conditions and external pressure.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS WACR operating target weighted average call	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect WACR operating target through accounting, incentives and transmission	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Evaluate monetary effectiveness by inflation source, banking health, fiscal conditions and external pressure.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not assume a lower repo guarantees equal lending-rate reductions.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: WACR as the operating target converts a precise economic distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 6 - CORE - MPC architecture and flexible inflation targeting

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: MPC architecture and flexible inflation targeting explains how Monetary Policy Committee and Flexible inflation targeting fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, MPC architecture and flexible inflation targeting separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

MPC architecture and flexible inflation targeting must be read through Monetary Policy Committee and Flexible inflation targeting, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **architecture**
- **flexible**

- inflation
- targeting
- Monetary
- Committee

How to use them: Define architecture, flexible, inflation; attach targeting to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not merge the inflation target, tolerance band, repo rate and WACR operating target.

VISUAL FIRST

MPC ARCHITECTURE AND FLEXIBLE INFLATION TARGETING

01. Monetary Policy Committee

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02. Flexible inflation targeting

BOUNDARY -> Do not merge the inflation target, tolerance band, repo rate and WACR operating target.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The six-member MPC consists of the RBI Governor, the monetary-policy Deputy Governor, one RBI-nominated officer and three external members appointed by the Central Government, and decides the policy repo rate. India's framework uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a 4 per cent target and a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points while considering growth.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The six-member MPC consists of the RBI Governor, the monetary-policy Deputy Governor, one RBI-nominated officer and three external members appointed by the Central Government, and decides the policy repo rate.
- India's framework uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a 4 per cent target and a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points while considering growth.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not merge the inflation target, tolerance band, repo rate and WACR operating target.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Conclude with credible communication, flexible operations and realistic limits on rate policy.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Monetary Policy Committee -> Flexible inflation targeting
- **Qualified use:** Conclude with credible communication, flexible operations and realistic limits on rate policy.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS architecture flexible inflation targeting Monetary Committee	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Monetary Policy Committee and Flexible inflation targeting through accounting, incentives and transmission	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Conclude with credible communication, flexible operations and realistic limits on rate policy.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not merge the inflation target, tolerance band, repo rate and WACR operating target.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MPC architecture and flexible inflation targeting converts a precise economic distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 7 - CORE - RBI's statutory mandate

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: RBI's statutory mandate explains how Statutory RBI status fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, RBI's statutory mandate separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

RBI's statutory mandate must be read through Statutory RBI status, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- RBI's
- statutory
- mandate
- status
- body
- under

How to use them: Define RBI's, statutory, mandate; attach status to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not treat SDF as collateralised borrowing; it is uncollateralised absorption.

VISUAL FIRST

RBI'S STATUTORY MANDATE

01. Statutory RBI status

BOUNDARY -> Do not treat SDF as collateralised borrowing; it is uncollateralised absorption.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional body; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government and RBI performs monetary, currency, banking, reserve and payment functions.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional body; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government and RBI performs monetary, currency, banking, reserve and payment functions.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not treat SDF as collateralised borrowing; it is uncollateralised absorption.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Separate the repo signal from liquidity implementation and then trace pass-through.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Statutory RBI status
- **Qualified use:** Separate the repo signal from liquidity implementation and then trace pass-through.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS RBI's statutory mandate status body under	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Statutory RBI status through accounting, incentives and transmission	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Separate the repo signal from liquidity implementation and then trace pass-through.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not treat SDF as collateralised borrowing; it is uncollateralised absorption.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RBI's statutory mandate converts a precise economic distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 8 - CORE - From policy signal to macro outcome

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: From policy signal to macro outcome explains how Transmission chain fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, From policy signal to macro outcome separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

From policy signal to macro outcome must be read through Transmission chain, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- From
- signal
- macro
- outcome
- Transmission
- chain

How to use them: Define From, signal, macro; attach outcome to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not say CRR and OMO have the same mechanics or time horizon.

VISUAL FIRST

FROM POLICY SIGNAL TO MACRO OUTCOME

01. Transmission chain

BOUNDARY -> Do not say CRR and OMO have the same mechanics or time horizon.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not say CRR and OMO have the same mechanics or time horizon.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Evaluate monetary effectiveness by inflation source, banking health, fiscal conditions and external pressure.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Transmission chain
- **Qualified use:** Evaluate monetary effectiveness by inflation source, banking health, fiscal conditions and external pressure.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS From signal macro outcome Transmission chain	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Transmission chain through accounting, incentives and transmission	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Evaluate monetary effectiveness by inflation source, banking health, fiscal conditions and external pressure.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not say CRR and OMO have the same mechanics or time horizon.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: From policy signal to macro outcome converts a precise economic distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 9 - CORE - Why liquidity management differs from stance

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Why liquidity management differs from stance explains how SDF-liquidity distinction fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, Why liquidity management differs from stance separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Why liquidity management differs from stance must be read through SDF-liquidity distinction, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- liquidity
- management
- differs
- from
- stance
- SDF-liquidity

How to use them: Define liquidity, management, differs; attach from to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Liquidity management aligns market rates with the operating framework; it is distinct from a fresh change in the monetary-policy stance.

VISUAL FIRST

WHY LIQUIDITY MANAGEMENT DIFFERS FROM STANCE

01. SDF-liquidity distinction

BOUNDARY -> Liquidity management aligns market rates with the operating framework; it is distinct from a fresh change in the monetary-policy stance.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The 2022 SDF illustrates that RBI can absorb collateral-free surplus liquidity to align overnight rates without necessarily changing the repo-rate stance.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The 2022 SDF illustrates that RBI can absorb collateral-free surplus liquidity to align overnight rates without necessarily changing the repo-rate stance.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Liquidity management aligns market rates with the operating framework; it is distinct from a fresh change in the monetary-policy stance.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Conclude with credible communication, flexible operations and realistic limits on rate policy.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** SDF-liquidity distinction
- **Qualified use:** Conclude with credible communication, flexible operations and realistic limits on rate policy.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS liquidity management differs from stance SDF-liquidity	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect SDF-liquidity distinction through accounting, incentives and transmission	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Conclude with credible communication, flexible operations and realistic limits on rate policy.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Liquidity management aligns market rates with the operating framework; it is distinct from a fresh change in the monetary-policy stance.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Why liquidity management differs from stance converts a precise economic distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 10 - CORE - Pandemic multi-instrument easing

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Pandemic multi-instrument easing explains how Pandemic policy package fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, Pandemic multi-instrument easing separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Pandemic multi-instrument easing must be read through Pandemic policy package, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Pandemic**
- **multi-instrument**

- easing
- package
- During
- combined

How to use them: Define Pandemic, multi-instrument, easing; attach package to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not claim monetary policy can directly repair food, energy or logistics shortages.

VISUAL FIRST

PANDEMIC MULTI-INSTRUMENT EASING

01. Pandemic policy package

BOUNDARY -> Do not claim monetary policy can directly repair food, energy or logistics shortages.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

During the pandemic RBI combined repo reductions with CRR easing, OMOs and targeted longer-term liquidity operations, showing that expansionary policy is an instrument package rather than a repo cut alone.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- During the pandemic RBI combined repo reductions with CRR easing, OMOs and targeted longer-term liquidity operations, showing that expansionary policy is an instrument package rather than a repo cut alone.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not claim monetary policy can directly repair food, energy or logistics shortages.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Separate the repo signal from liquidity implementation and then trace pass-through.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Pandemic policy package
- **Qualified use:** Separate the repo signal from liquidity implementation and then trace pass-through.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Pandemic multi-instrument easing package During combined	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Pandemic policy package through accounting, incentives and transmission	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Separate the repo signal from liquidity implementation and then trace pass-through.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not claim monetary policy can directly repair food, energy or logistics shortages.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Pandemic multi-instrument easing converts a precise economic distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 11 - CORE - Uneven pass-through and forex sterilisation

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Uneven pass-through and forex sterilisation explains how Uneven pass-through and Forex intervention and sterilisation fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, Uneven pass-through and forex sterilisation separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Uneven pass-through and forex sterilisation must be read through Uneven pass-through and Forex intervention and sterilisation, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Uneven
- pass-through
- forex
- sterilisation
- intervention
- Post-pandemic

How to use them: Define Uneven, pass-through, forex; attach sterilisation to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not generalise a payment-system storage direction into a law for all data.

VISUAL FIRST

UNEVEN PASS-THROUGH AND FOREX STERILISATION

01. Uneven pass-through

|
v

02. Forex intervention and sterilisation

BOUNDARY -> Do not generalise a payment-system storage direction into a law for all data.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ. RBI may sell or buy foreign exchange to smooth excessive rupee volatility and offset the domestic-liquidity effect through OMOs or absorption operations; sterilisation does not imply a fixed exchange-rate promise.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ.
- RBI may sell or buy foreign exchange to smooth excessive rupee volatility and offset the domestic-liquidity effect through OMOs or absorption operations; sterilisation does not imply a fixed exchange-rate promise.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not generalise a payment-system storage direction into a law for all data.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Evaluate monetary effectiveness by inflation source, banking health, fiscal conditions and external pressure.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Uneven pass-through -> Forex intervention and sterilisation
- **Qualified use:** Evaluate monetary effectiveness by inflation source, banking health, fiscal conditions and external pressure.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Uneven pass-through forex sterilisation intervention Post-pandemic	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Uneven pass-through and Forex intervention and sterilisation through accounting, incentives and transmission	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Evaluate monetary effectiveness by inflation source, banking health, fiscal conditions and external pressure.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not generalise a payment-system storage direction into a law for all data.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Uneven pass-through and forex sterilisation converts a precise economic distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 12 - CORE - OMO effects on yields and conditions

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: OMO effects on yields and conditions explains how OMO and yield conditions fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, OMO effects on yields and conditions separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

OMO effects on yields and conditions must be read through OMO and yield conditions, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- effects
- yields
- conditions
- yield
- affects
- durable

How to use them: Define effects, yields, conditions; attach yield to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not mismatch reform committees with their sponsoring institution or subject.

VISUAL FIRST

OMO EFFECTS ON YIELDS AND CONDITIONS

01. OMO and yield conditions

BOUNDARY -> Do not mismatch reform committees with their sponsoring institution or subject.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not mismatch reform committees with their sponsoring institution or subject.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Conclude with credible communication, flexible operations and realistic limits on rate policy.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** OMO and yield conditions
- **Qualified use:** Conclude with credible communication, flexible operations and realistic limits on rate policy.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS effects yields conditions yield affects durable	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect OMO and yield conditions through accounting, incentives and transmission	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Conclude with credible communication, flexible operations and realistic limits on rate policy.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not mismatch reform committees with their sponsoring institution or subject.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: OMO effects on yields and conditions converts a precise economic distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 13 - CORE SYNTHESIS - Legal tender and RBI liabilities

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Legal tender and RBI liabilities explains how Legal tender and RBI liabilities fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, Legal tender and RBI liabilities separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Legal tender and RBI liabilities must be read through Legal tender and RBI liabilities, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Legal
- tender
- liabilities
- must
- accepted
- settlement

How to use them: Define Legal, tender, liabilities; attach must to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not equate every liquidity injection with a repo-rate cut.

VISUAL FIRST

LEGAL TENDER AND RBI LIABILITIES

01. Legal tender and RBI liabilities

BOUNDARY -> Do not equate every liquidity injection with a repo-rate cut.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Legal tender must be accepted in settlement within the legal framework, and Indian currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet rather than RBI income.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Legal tender must be accepted in settlement within the legal framework, and Indian currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet rather than RBI income.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not equate every liquidity injection with a repo-rate cut.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Separate the repo signal from liquidity implementation and then trace pass-through.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Legal tender and RBI liabilities
- **Qualified use:** Separate the repo signal from liquidity implementation and then trace pass-through.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Legal tender liabilities must accepted settlement	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Legal tender and RBI liabilities through accounting, incentives and transmission	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Separate the repo signal from liquidity implementation and then trace pass-through.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not equate every liquidity injection with a repo-rate cut.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Legal tender and RBI liabilities converts a precise economic distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 14 - CORE SYNTHESIS - Money multiplier and RBI income

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Money multiplier and RBI income explains how Money multiplier and RBI income sources fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, Money multiplier and RBI income separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Money multiplier and RBI income must be read through Money multiplier and RBI income sources, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Money
- multiplier
- income

- sources
- Reserve
- supports

How to use them: Define Money, multiplier, income; attach sources to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not treat OMO and repo as identical; one is outright and the other is a repurchase transaction.

VISUAL FIRST

MONEY MULTIPLIER AND RBI INCOME

01. Money multiplier

|

v

02. RBI income sources

BOUNDARY -> Do not treat OMO and repo as identical; one is outright and the other is a repurchase transaction.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Reserve money supports broader money creation through banking; lower reserve impounding and currency leakage and greater willingness to lend generally raise the money multiplier. RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from banking and market functions.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Reserve money supports broader money creation through banking; lower reserve impounding and currency leakage and greater willingness to lend generally raise the money multiplier.
- RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from banking and market functions.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not treat OMO and repo as identical; one is outright and the other is a repurchase transaction.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Evaluate monetary effectiveness by inflation source, banking health, fiscal conditions and external pressure.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Money multiplier -> RBI income sources
- **Qualified use:** Evaluate monetary effectiveness by inflation source, banking health, fiscal conditions and external pressure.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Money multiplier income sources Reserve supports	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Money multiplier and RBI income sources through accounting, incentives and transmission	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Evaluate monetary effectiveness by inflation source, banking health, fiscal conditions and external pressure.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not treat OMO and repo as identical; one is outright and the other is a repurchase transaction.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Money multiplier and RBI income converts a precise economic distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 15 - CORE SYNTHESIS - Payment directions and committee pairs

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Payment directions and committee pairs explains how Payment-data direction and Committee-institution pairs fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, Payment directions and committee pairs separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Payment directions and committee pairs must be read through Payment-data direction and Committee-institution pairs, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Payment
- directions
- committee
- pairs
- Payment-data
- direction

How to use them: Define Payment, directions, committee; attach pairs to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not assume ordinary NBFCs have routine LAF access like scheduled banks.

VISUAL FIRST

PAYMENT DIRECTIONS AND COMMITTEE PAIRS

01. Payment-data direction

|

v

02. Committee-institution pairs

BOUNDARY -> Do not assume ordinary NBFCs have routine LAF access like scheduled banks.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a regulated payments direction, not a universal data-localisation law. The Hilton-Young Commission concerns colonial currency and central-banking reform, Narasimham Committees concern Government of India banking reform, and the Tarapore Committee concerns RBI work on capital-account convertibility.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a regulated payments direction, not a universal data-localisation law.
- The Hilton-Young Commission concerns colonial currency and central-banking reform, Narasimham Committees concern Government of India banking reform, and the Tarapore Committee concerns RBI work on capital-account convertibility.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not assume ordinary NBFCs have routine LAF access like scheduled banks.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.

- **Mains:** Conclude with credible communication, flexible operations and realistic limits on rate policy.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Payment-data direction -> Committee-institution pairs
- **Qualified use:** Conclude with credible communication, flexible operations and realistic limits on rate policy.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Payment directions committee pairs Payment-data direction	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Payment-data direction and Committee-institution pairs through accounting, incentives and transmission	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Conclude with credible communication, flexible operations and realistic limits on rate policy.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not assume ordinary NBFCs have routine LAF access like scheduled banks.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Payment directions and committee pairs converts a precise economic distinction into a qualified conclusion			

COMPLETE BASIC OWNER EVIDENCE BANK

Subject: Economy | **Tier:** Must-Do (foundation) | **GS Paper:** GS-III + Prelims. **Core area:** Monetary policy.
Grounded in: Ramesh Singh, relevant chapters; Economic Survey 2025-26; audited UPSC Economy PYQs (2024-2026 Prelims and 2024-2025 Mains). **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = analytical linkage | **CURRENT:** = current Survey/current-affairs hook. *Companion:*
 ../advanced/04_RBI-Monetary-Policy-and-Liquidity-Management.md.

1. Visual foundation

1. MPC POLICY SIGNAL
|
v
2. MONEY-MARKET RATES
|
v
3. BANK FUNDING AND DEPOSIT RATES
|
v
4. LENDING RATES AND ASSET PRICES
|
v
5. DEMAND, OUTPUT AND INFLATION

Core proposition: Separate the policy-rate signal from liquidity implementation and then trace pass-through through markets, banks, borrowers and expectations.

2. Essential definitions

Concept	Exam-ready meaning
FACT: Repo rate	Policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework.
FACT: Standing Deposit Facility (SDF)	Uncollateralised facility for RBI to absorb liquidity.
FACT: MSF	Overnight emergency borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities.
FACT: CRR	Share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI.
FACT: OMO	Outright RBI purchase or sale of government securities to alter durable liquidity.
FACT: Operating target	The WACR is the rate RBI seeks to keep aligned with the policy corridor through liquidity operations.
FACT: Legal tender money	Money that must be accepted in settlement of obligations within the legal framework; Indian currency notes are RBI liabilities.
FACT: Money multiplier	The process through which reserve money supports broader money creation through banking; lower leakages and lower reserve impounding raise it.
FACT: Sterilisation	RBI action to offset the domestic-liquidity effect of forex intervention, often through OMOs or other absorption operations.

3. Topic mechanism

1. The MPC changes the repo rate and communicates its inflation-growth assessment.
2. RBI liquidity operations keep the weighted average call rate aligned with the operating framework.
3. Money-market rates influence bank deposit costs, bond yields and external benchmark-linked lending rates.
4. Borrowing costs, credit availability, asset prices and expectations alter consumption and investment.
5. Aggregate demand and inflation respond with lags that depend on banking health, competition and fiscal conditions.

4. Institutions and policy tools

- FACT: **Monetary Policy Committee**: six members - RBI Governor, Deputy Governor in charge of monetary policy, one RBI-nominated officer and three Central Government appointed external members - decide the policy repo rate.
- FACT: **Flexible inflation-targeting framework**: the MPC uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a target of **4% +/- 2** while keeping growth in mind.
- FACT: **RBI Governor and Central Board**: RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, and the Governor is appointed by the Central Government; RBI is not a constitutional body.
- FACT: **RBI Financial Markets Operations Department**: conducts liquidity operations, OMOs and market interventions.
- FACT: **Scheduled commercial banks and primary dealers**: transmit policy through money, credit and government-securities markets.
- FACT: **RBI's reserve-management and payment-system functions**: smooth excessive rupee volatility and supervise payment-system rules, including data-storage directions for regulated entities.

5. Indian applications and examples

- ANALYSIS: **Claim:** Monetary policy in India is now institutionally rule-bound rather than purely discretionary. **Named evidence/example:** The 2016 adoption of the Monetary Policy Committee and flexible inflation-targeting framework made headline CPI and the repo decision central to policy communication. **Why it supports the claim:** It shows that repo changes are anchored to an explicit inflation objective and collective decision-making structure, not just the Governor's personal view. **Limit/status caution:** A rule-based framework still faces supply shocks and fiscal-external pressures that cannot be neutralised by interest-rate policy alone.
- ANALYSIS: **Claim:** Liquidity management is distinct from the policy-rate signal. **Named evidence/example:** The introduction of the Standing Deposit Facility in 2022 gave RBI a collateral-free absorption tool for surplus liquidity. **Why it supports the claim:** It demonstrates that RBI can align overnight rates with the corridor even when the core issue is excess liquidity, not a fresh repo-rate change. **Limit/status caution:** Absorbing liquidity stabilises the operating target, but it does not automatically ensure full transmission to every borrower or depositor.
- ANALYSIS: **Claim:** Expansionary monetary policy works through several instruments, not repo cuts alone. **Named evidence/example:** During the pandemic phase, RBI used repo reductions along with CRR easing, OMOs and targeted longer-term liquidity operations such as TLTRO-style support. **Why it supports the claim:** It shows how rate action, durable liquidity and market backstops are combined when the financial system faces stress. **Limit/status caution:** Abundant liquidity cannot by itself force credit uptake when firms are risk-averse and banks are cautious.
- ANALYSIS: **Claim:** Transmission in India is real but uneven and lagged. **Named evidence/example:** Repo hikes in the post-pandemic inflation phase fed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and older loan books. **Why it supports the claim:** It gives a concrete exam example of how policy moves through bank pricing, borrowers' EMLs and eventually demand conditions. **Limit/status caution:** Funding mix, small-savings competition, term deposits, bank balance-sheet strength and credit risk mean pass-through is never perfectly uniform.
- ANALYSIS: **Claim:** RBI must often balance domestic monetary goals with external-stability pressures. **Named evidence/example:** During periods of rupee depreciation pressure, RBI uses foreign-exchange intervention to smooth volatility and may sterilise the resulting liquidity effects through OMOs or absorption tools. **Why it supports the claim:** It proves that exchange-rate management, liquidity management and inflation control are linked in practice even under a flexible exchange-rate regime. **Limit/status caution:** RBI smooths excessive volatility; it does not promise a fixed rupee-dollar level and cannot permanently override global shocks.
- ANALYSIS: **Claim:** Open-market operations influence more than short-term cash conditions. **Named evidence/example:** RBI's OMO purchases or sales in the government-securities market alter durable liquidity and can affect yields across maturities. **Why it supports the claim:** This helps answers distinguish repo from OMO and explain sterilisation, yield management and transmission to broader financial conditions. **Limit/status caution:** OMO effects depend on market expectations, government borrowing conditions and the broader stance; they are not identical to a policy-rate change.

6A. Limitations and trade-offs

- ANALYSIS: Tight policy helps inflation credibility and the rupee, but excessive tightening can weaken investment, housing demand, MSME cash flow and employment.
- ANALYSIS: Surplus liquidity can support growth and market functioning, yet if it persists during inflationary conditions it can blunt disinflation and fuel asset-price risk.
- ANALYSIS: Repo changes transmit faster to some floating-rate loans than to all deposit rates or legacy loans, so the burden of adjustment is uneven across sectors and households.
- ANALYSIS: CRR is a broad and powerful liquidity tool, but it is blunt; using it repeatedly can strain bank intermediation more than corridor or market operations.
- ANALYSIS: Forex intervention can smooth excessive volatility, but large or repeated intervention raises sterilisation and reserve-management trade-offs.
- ANALYSIS: Monetary policy can restrain demand and expectations, but it cannot directly solve food shortages, imported energy shocks or structural banking weakness.

6. Must-Know Facts for Prelims

- FACT: RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional authority; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government.
- FACT: RBI is the monetary authority, currency issuer, banker to government and banks, reserve manager, payment-system regulator and lender of last resort within statutory mandates.
- FACT: The Monetary Policy Committee has six members - three from RBI and three external members appointed by the Central Government - and it decides the policy repo rate.
- FACT: India's flexible inflation-targeting framework uses headline CPI with a target of **4%** and a tolerance band of **+/- 2**.
- FACT: WACR is the operating target of the liquidity-management framework.
- FACT: The policy target, tolerance band, repo rate and operating target are distinct.
- FACT: Repo signals the stance; SDF absorbs surplus liquidity without collateral; MSF provides overnight backstop borrowing; CRR impounds bank resources; OMO changes durable liquidity through outright bond trades.
- FACT: A repo injects liquidity against collateral; reverse-style absorption removes liquidity.
- FACT: CRR changes affect lendable resources broadly, while OMO changes durable system liquidity through securities transactions.
- FACT: Legal tender money must be accepted within the legal framework in settlement of obligations; currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet.
- FACT: Money multiplier generally rises when reserve impounding and currency leakage fall and when banks are willing to lend rather than hold excess reserves.
- FACT: Expansionary monetary policy can include repo cuts, CRR cuts, OMO purchases and longer-term liquidity operations.
- FACT: Sterilisation means offsetting the domestic-liquidity effect of forex intervention, often through OMO or absorption operations.
- FACT: Measures against rupee depreciation can include RBI forex sales to smooth volatility, monetary tightening to support rupee returns and wider policy steps affecting the external balance.
- FACT: RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, returns from liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from its banking and market functions.
- FACT: RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a payments-regulation measure, not a general data policy.
- FACT: Frequently tested committee-institution pairs: Hilton-Young Commission with colonial currency and central-banking reform; Narasimham Committees with Government of India banking-sector reform; Tarapore Committee with RBI on capital-account convertibility.
- FACT: Monetary policy works with lags and cannot directly remove sector-specific supply bottlenecks.

7. UPSC traps

- WRONG: Every liquidity injection is a rate cut. -> Liquidity quantity and the policy-rate stance are distinct.
- WRONG: OMO and repo are identical. -> OMO is an outright transaction; repo is collateralised with repurchase.
- WRONG: NBFCs generally access LAF like scheduled banks. -> Direct access is institution- and facility-specific; the 2024 PYQ rejected the broad claim.
- WRONG: Currency notes are RBI income. -> Notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet.
- WRONG: A lower repo guarantees equal lending-rate cuts. -> Funding mix, deposits, risk and balance sheets affect pass-through.

8. CURRENT: Economic Survey 2025-26 / current anchor

- CURRENT: WACR averaged 8 basis points below the repo rate in FY26 up to 8 Jan 2026.

- CURRENT: M3 showed 12.1% year-on-year growth in the Survey's FY26 liquidity snapshot.
- CURRENT: The Survey links repo easing, CRR changes and OMOs with improved market transmission.

ANALYSIS: **Interpretation caution:** A rate change cannot directly create food supply, repair a stalled project or recapitalise a weak borrower.

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: 2025 Prelims tested RBI income sources: government securities and foreign-currency operations.
- ANALYSIS: 2024 Prelims tested that NBFCs do not broadly enjoy direct LAF access.
- FACT: **2026 Prelims Q2 (official provisional key):** tested why the

Hilton-Young Commission's fixed rupee-sterling rate aided British remittances and India's creditworthiness. This is monetary history, not an MPC instrument. Exact route: . . /README .md.

10. Mains angles

- ANALYSIS: Explain policy through the sequence: diagnosis, MPC decision, liquidity alignment, transmission and macro outcome.
- ANALYSIS: Evaluate effectiveness using inflation source, banking health, pass-through, fiscal stance and external conditions.
- ANALYSIS: Recommend deep markets, competitive banking, clear communication and supply-side coordination.

Answer thesis: Separate the policy-rate signal from liquidity implementation and then trace pass-through through markets, banks, borrowers and expectations.

11. Probable questions

- ANALYSIS: **Prelims:** Match repo, SDF, MSF, CRR and OMO with their liquidity effects and eligible counterparties.
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (10 marks):** Explain why liquidity management is necessary even after the MPC announces a repo-rate decision.
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** Evaluate the obstacles to complete monetary-policy transmission in India.

11A. Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

Directive decoder

- ANALYSIS: **Discuss:** define the instrument set first, then trace how repo and liquidity operations move through markets, banks and inflation.
- ANALYSIS: **Examine / Analyse:** separate institutional design (MPC, target, corridor) from transmission (WACR, bank rates, credit, expectations) and from external management (forex intervention, sterilisation).
- ANALYSIS: **Critically examine / Evaluate:** after explaining the toolkit, add why transmission is incomplete, why supply shocks limit monetary power and what growth costs tighter policy can create.
- ANALYSIS: **Compare / Justify:** for prompts such as *repo vs OMO* or *liquidity management vs monetary stance*, compare objective, instrument mechanics, transmission channel and time horizon, then justify why both are needed together.

Evidence chain: 2016 MPC/FIT framework + 2022 SDF introduction + pandemic repo/CRR/OMO/TLTRO easing + post-pandemic transmission into EBLR and deposits + rupee-volatility intervention with sterilisation + OMO yield/liquidity example.

Counter-evidence: Use **6A. Limitations and trade-offs** to show that inflation control, liquidity support, exchange-rate smoothing and growth support cannot all be maximised simultaneously.

10/15/20-mark scaling:

- ANALYSIS: **10 marks**: thesis + 2-3 named tools/examples + one transmission or limitation point.
- ANALYSIS: **15 marks**: thesis + 4-5 evidence units covering MPC design, liquidity tools and transmission + one counter-dimension.
- ANALYSIS: **20 marks**: thesis + 5-6 evidence units spanning institutional design, monetary stance, liquidity, external stability and limits of pass-through + balanced conclusion from **6A**.

Reasoned verdict template: ANALYSIS: *In India, sound monetary policy is not merely about moving the repo rate; it is about combining a credible CPI target, flexible liquidity operations and realistic transmission management while accepting that growth, inflation and external stability pull policy in different directions.*

12. Study links

- FACT: Advanced companion:
../advanced/04_RBI-Monetary-Policy-and-Liquidity-Management.md.
- FACT: 03_Inflation-Price-Indices-and-Business-Cycles.md - the objective and inflation diagnosis.
- FACT: 05_Banking-Structure-NBFCs-and-Financial-Regulation.md - institutions carrying transmission.
- FACT: 07_Money-Market-Capital-Market-and-Financial-Instruments.md - overnight rates and yield curves.

2026 PYQ Integration

Status: 2026 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2026.md. **Answer-key rule:** The 2026 Prelims and CSAT Set-A keys held locally are **provisional**; no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Year represented:** 2026
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2026	Prelims GS-I	98	Indian financial-sector reform committees and their institutional sponsors	Objective question; provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally, answer not inferred	Provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally (Ans - ■2026-■GS1-■Provisional); key is provisional - no answer letter recorded or inferred here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Indian financial-sector reform committees and their institutional sponsors

This block integrates the 2026 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 blocks and does not convert a provisionally-keyed, answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2024-2025.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2024-2025 Prelims Set-A keys are present in the repository and CSAT Set-A keys are supplied; even so, no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Years represented:** 2025
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2025	Prelims GS-I	2	Sources of income of the Reserve Bank of India	Objective question; official Set-A key available locally, answer not inferred	Key available locally (official Set-A answer key present); answer not recorded here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Sources of income of the Reserve Bank of India

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 12

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	Prelims GS-I	46	Legal tender money definition and characteristics	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2019	Prelims GS-I	86	Government and RBI measures to prevent rupee depreciation	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2019	Prelims GS-I	87	RBI payment data storage directive for system providers	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2019	Prelims GS-I	90	Conditions that increase money multiplier in economy	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2020	Prelims GS-I	57	RBI expansionist monetary policy instruments and actions	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2021	Prelims GS-I	1	RBI Governor appointment and constitutional powers	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Monetary-policy specialist plus statutory-not-constitutional regulator classification; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2021	Prelims GS-I	11	Money multiplier and reserve ratios in banking	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2021	Prelims GS-I	15	Central bank lender of last resort function	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2022	Prelims GS-I	3	RBI monetary policy tools and rupee management	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2022	Prelims GS-I	68	Institution responsible for price stability and inflation control	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2023	Prelims GS-I	22	Central banks interest rate hikes post-pandemic monetary policy	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2023	Prelims GS-I	24	RBI sterilization and Open Market Operations role	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Legal tender money definition and characteristics
- Government and RBI measures to prevent rupee depreciation
- RBI payment data storage directive for system providers
- Conditions that increase money multiplier in economy

- RBI expansionist monetary policy instruments and actions
- RBI Governor appointment and constitutional powers
- Money multiplier and reserve ratios in banking
- Central bank lender of last resort function
- RBI monetary policy tools and rupee management
- Institution responsible for price stability and inflation control
- Central banks interest rate hikes post-pandemic monetary policy
- RBI sterilization and Open Market Operations role

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control

- **Official syllabus/index and owned core:** RBI monetary policy works through the policy rate, liquidity framework, money-market rates, bank funding and lending conditions, asset prices, expectations, exchange rate, demand and inflation with variable lags.
- **Indispensable distinction and prerequisite taxonomy:** Repo policy rate is not every liquidity operation, liquidity surplus is not solvency, CRR is not SLR, stance is not a mechanical promise, and announcement is not complete transmission.
- **Mechanism, implementation and evidence control:** Preserve RBI Act, MPC, operating target and instrument mandates; state decision date, policy window and status, then qualify pass-through by deposit structure, credit risk, fiscal conditions, supply shocks and external finance.
- **FACT: Verified current fact (official sources rechecked 5 September 2026):**

Rechecked 6 September 2026 against the listed official publisher or regulator source. The RBI Monetary Policy page was reachable only as raw HTML in this run. No current repo rate, stance, reserve ratio, liquidity amount or meeting outcome was extracted; the package relies on the audited owners for stable instrument mechanics and preserves every counterparty and legal distinction. Sources: <https://www.rbi.org.in/Scripts/Annualpolicy.aspx>

- **ANALYSIS: Analytical inference:** institutional design, allocation, a portal, a registration, a report, a training completion, a disposal count or a ranking can support a causal argument only after authority, capacity, incentives, distribution, implementation, grievance, outcome and alternative explanations are tested.

- **Canonical and cross-owner boundary:** this Economy owner teaches the authority-to-delivery-to-remedy chain. Detailed constitutional doctrine stays with Polity; sector entitlement design stays with Social Justice; macro-fiscal doctrine stays with Economy; ethics theory stays with Ethics. Cross-owner evidence may be routed but is not silently duplicated or re-owned.

- **Four-ledger hostile audit:** literal syllabus, indispensable prerequisites, standard public-administration/economy taxonomy and complete verified PYQ demands were checked for absent concepts, institutions, mechanisms, classifications, exceptions, comparisons, criticisms, current status, answer architecture and dependent artifacts.

- **Verified PYQ ownership, 2018-2026:** This Basic owner carries audited objective routes on legal tender, rupee management, payment-data storage, the money multiplier, expansionary instruments, RBI status, lender of last resort, interest-rate hikes, sterilisation, RBI income and reform committees. No routed Mains demand is manufactured and no unavailable or provisional objective answer is inferred.

ECONOMY DEEP-REVIEW CORE CONTROL

- **Must remember:** RBI monetary policy works through the policy rate, liquidity framework, money-market rates, bank funding and lending conditions, asset prices, expectations, exchange rate, demand and inflation with variable lags.
- **Close distinction:** Repo policy rate is not every liquidity operation, liquidity surplus is not solvency, CRR is not SLR, stance is not a mechanical promise, and announcement is not complete transmission.
- **Formula / status / evidence / causal limit:** Preserve RBI Act, MPC, operating target and instrument mandates; state decision date, policy window and status, then qualify pass-through by deposit structure, credit risk, fiscal conditions, supply shocks and external finance.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Repo-rate signal?

A. The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection. B. CRR is the share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI, broadly impounding bank resources and affecting lendable funds. C. The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022. D. MSF is an overnight backstop borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities; its counterparty and emergency role differ from ordinary repo operations.

Answer: A. Explanation: The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q2. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Repo-rate signal?

A. CRR is the share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI, broadly impounding bank resources and affecting lendable funds. B. The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection. C. OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions. D. MSF is an overnight backstop borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities; its counterparty and emergency role differ from ordinary repo operations.

Answer: B. Explanation: The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q3. Which statement uses Repo-rate signal without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. CRR is the share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI, broadly impounding bank resources and affecting lendable funds. B. OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions. C. The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection. D. The weighted average call rate is the operating target that RBI liquidity operations seek to align with the policy corridor; the policy target, repo rate and operating target are distinct.

Answer: C. Explanation: The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q4. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Repo-rate signal?

A. OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions. B. The weighted average call rate is the operating target that RBI liquidity operations seek to align with the policy corridor; the policy target, repo rate and operating target are distinct. C. The six-member MPC consists of the RBI Governor, the monetary-policy Deputy Governor, one RBI-nominated officer and three external members appointed by the Central Government, and decides the policy repo rate. D. The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection.

Answer: D. Explanation: The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Standing Deposit Facility?

A. The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022. B. CRR is the share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI, broadly impounding bank resources and affecting lendable funds. C. MSF is an overnight backstop borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities; its counterparty and emergency role differ from ordinary repo operations. D. OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions.

Answer: A. Explanation: The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q6. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Standing Deposit Facility?

A. OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions. B. The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022. C. The weighted average call rate is the operating target that RBI liquidity operations seek to align with the policy corridor; the policy target, repo rate and operating target are distinct. D. CRR is the share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI, broadly impounding bank resources and affecting lendable funds.

Answer: B. Explanation: The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q7. Which statement uses Standing Deposit Facility without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The weighted average call rate is the operating target that RBI liquidity operations seek to align with the policy corridor; the policy target, repo rate and operating target are distinct. B. OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions. C. The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022. D. The six-member MPC consists of the RBI Governor, the monetary-policy Deputy Governor, one RBI-nominated officer and three external members appointed by the Central Government, and decides the policy repo rate.

Answer: C. Explanation: The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q8. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Standing Deposit Facility?

A. The weighted average call rate is the operating target that RBI liquidity operations seek to align with the policy corridor; the policy target, repo rate and operating target are distinct. B. The six-member MPC consists of the RBI Governor, the monetary-policy Deputy Governor, one RBI-nominated officer and three external members appointed by the Central Government, and decides the policy repo rate. C. India's framework uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a 4 per cent target and a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points while considering growth. D. The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022.

Answer: D. Explanation: The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Marginal Standing Facility?

A. MSF is an overnight backstop borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities; its counterparty and emergency role differ from ordinary repo operations. B. CRR is the share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI, broadly impounding bank resources and affecting lendable funds. C. The weighted average call rate is the operating target that RBI liquidity operations seek to align with the policy corridor; the policy target, repo rate and operating target are distinct. D. OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions.

Answer: A. Explanation: MSF is an overnight backstop borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities; its counterparty and emergency role differ from ordinary repo operations. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q10. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Marginal Standing Facility?

A. The six-member MPC consists of the RBI Governor, the monetary-policy Deputy Governor, one RBI-nominated officer and three external members appointed by the Central Government, and decides the policy repo rate. B. MSF is an overnight backstop borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities; its counterparty and emergency role differ from ordinary repo operations. C. The weighted average call rate is the operating target that RBI liquidity operations seek to align with the policy corridor; the policy target, repo rate and operating target are distinct. D. OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions.

Answer: B. Explanation: MSF is an overnight backstop borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities; its counterparty and emergency role differ from ordinary repo operations. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q11. Which statement uses Marginal Standing Facility without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The six-member MPC consists of the RBI Governor, the monetary-policy Deputy Governor, one RBI-nominated officer and three external members appointed by the Central Government, and decides the policy repo rate. B. The weighted average call rate is the operating target that RBI liquidity operations seek to align with the policy corridor; the policy target, repo rate and operating target are distinct. C. MSF is an overnight backstop borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities; its counterparty and emergency role differ from ordinary repo operations. D. India's framework uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a 4 per cent target and a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points while considering growth.

Answer: C. Explanation: MSF is an overnight backstop borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities; its counterparty and emergency role differ from ordinary repo operations. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q12. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Marginal Standing Facility?

A. The six-member MPC consists of the RBI Governor, the monetary-policy Deputy Governor, one RBI-nominated officer and three external members appointed by the Central Government, and decides the policy repo rate. B. India's framework uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a 4 per cent target and a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points while considering growth. C. RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional body; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government and RBI performs monetary, currency, banking, reserve and payment functions. D. MSF is an overnight backstop borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities; its counterparty and emergency role differ from ordinary repo operations.

Answer: D. Explanation: MSF is an overnight backstop borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities; its counterparty and emergency role differ from ordinary repo operations. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Cash Reserve Ratio?

A. CRR is the share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI, broadly impounding bank resources and affecting lendable funds. B. OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions. C. The weighted average call rate is the operating target that RBI liquidity operations seek to align with the policy corridor; the policy target, repo rate and operating target are distinct. D. The six-member MPC consists of the RBI Governor, the monetary-policy Deputy Governor, one RBI-nominated officer and three external members appointed by the Central Government, and decides the policy repo rate.

Answer: A. Explanation: CRR is the share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI, broadly impounding bank resources and affecting lendable funds. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q14. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Cash Reserve Ratio?

A. The six-member MPC consists of the RBI Governor, the monetary-policy Deputy Governor, one RBI-nominated officer and three external members appointed by the Central Government, and decides the policy repo rate. B. CRR is the share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI, broadly impounding bank resources and affecting lendable funds. C. India's framework uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a 4 per cent target and a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points while considering growth. D. The weighted average call rate is the operating target that RBI liquidity operations seek to align with the policy corridor; the policy target, repo rate and operating target are distinct.

Answer: B. Explanation: CRR is the share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI, broadly impounding bank resources and affecting lendable funds. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q15. Which statement uses Cash Reserve Ratio without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional body; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government and RBI performs monetary, currency, banking, reserve and payment functions. B. India's framework uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a 4 per cent target and a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points while considering growth. C. CRR is the share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI, broadly impounding bank resources and affecting lendable funds. D. The six-member MPC consists of the RBI Governor, the monetary-policy Deputy Governor, one RBI-nominated officer and three external members appointed by the Central Government, and decides the policy repo rate.

Answer: C. Explanation: CRR is the share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI, broadly impounding bank resources and affecting lendable funds. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q16. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Cash Reserve Ratio?

A. MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags. B. India's framework uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a 4 per cent target and a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points while considering growth. C. RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional body; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government and RBI performs monetary, currency, banking, reserve and payment functions. D. CRR is the share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI, broadly impounding bank resources and affecting lendable funds.

Answer: D. Explanation: CRR is the share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI, broadly impounding bank resources and affecting lendable funds. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Open Market Operations?

A. OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions. B. India's framework uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a 4 per cent target and a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points while considering growth. C. The six-member MPC consists of the RBI Governor, the monetary-policy Deputy Governor, one RBI-nominated officer and three external members appointed by the Central Government, and decides the policy repo rate. D. The weighted average call rate is the operating target that RBI liquidity operations seek to align with the policy corridor; the policy target, repo rate and operating target are distinct.

Answer: A. Explanation: OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q18. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Open Market Operations?

A. RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional body; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government and RBI performs monetary, currency, banking, reserve and payment functions. B. OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions. C. India's framework uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a 4 per cent target and a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points while considering growth. D. The six-member MPC consists of the RBI Governor, the monetary-policy Deputy Governor, one RBI-nominated officer and three external members appointed by the Central Government, and decides the policy repo rate.

Answer: B. Explanation: OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q19. Which statement uses Open Market Operations without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional body; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government and RBI performs monetary, currency, banking, reserve and payment functions. B. MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags. C. OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions. D. India's framework uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a 4 per cent target and a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points while considering growth.

Answer: C. Explanation: OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q20. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Open Market Operations?

A. The 2022 SDF illustrates that RBI can absorb collateral-free surplus liquidity to align overnight rates without necessarily changing the repo-rate stance. B. MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags. C. RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional body; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government and RBI performs monetary, currency, banking, reserve and payment functions. D. OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions.

Answer: D. Explanation: OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies WACR operating target?

A. The weighted average call rate is the operating target that RBI liquidity operations seek to align with the policy corridor; the policy target, repo rate and operating target are distinct. B. India's framework uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a 4 per cent target and a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points while considering growth. C. RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional body; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government and RBI performs monetary, currency, banking, reserve and payment functions. D. The six-member MPC consists of the RBI Governor, the monetary-policy Deputy Governor, one RBI-nominated officer and three external members appointed by the Central Government, and decides the policy repo rate.

Answer: A. Explanation: The weighted average call rate is the operating target that RBI liquidity operations seek to align with the policy corridor; the policy target, repo rate and operating target are distinct. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q22. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of WACR operating target?

A. MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags. B. The weighted average call rate is the operating target that RBI liquidity operations seek to align with the policy corridor; the policy target, repo rate and operating target are distinct. C. RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional body; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government and RBI performs monetary, currency, banking, reserve and payment functions. D. India's framework uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a 4 per cent target and a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points while considering growth.

Answer: B. Explanation: The weighted average call rate is the operating target that RBI liquidity operations seek to align with the policy corridor; the policy target, repo rate and operating target are distinct. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q23. Which statement uses WACR operating target without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The 2022 SDF illustrates that RBI can absorb collateral-free surplus liquidity to align overnight rates without necessarily changing the repo-rate stance. B. RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional body; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government and RBI performs monetary, currency, banking, reserve and payment functions. C. The weighted average call rate is the operating target that RBI liquidity operations seek to align with the policy corridor; the policy target, repo rate and operating target are distinct. D. MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags.

Answer: C. Explanation: The weighted average call rate is the operating target that RBI liquidity operations seek to align with the policy corridor; the policy target, repo rate and operating target are distinct. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q24. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about WACR operating target?

A. During the pandemic RBI combined repo reductions with CRR easing, OMOs and targeted longer-term liquidity operations, showing that expansionary policy is an instrument package rather than a repo cut alone. B. The 2022 SDF illustrates that RBI can absorb collateral-free surplus liquidity to align overnight rates without necessarily changing the repo-rate stance. C. MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags. D. The weighted average call rate is the operating target that RBI liquidity operations seek to align with the policy corridor; the policy target, repo rate and operating target are distinct.

Answer: D. Explanation: The weighted average call rate is the operating target that RBI liquidity operations seek to align with the policy corridor; the policy target, repo rate and operating target are distinct. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Monetary Policy Committee?

A. The six-member MPC consists of the RBI Governor, the monetary-policy Deputy Governor, one RBI-nominated officer and three external members appointed by the Central Government, and decides the policy repo rate. B. MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags. C. RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional body; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government and RBI performs monetary, currency, banking, reserve and payment functions. D. India's framework uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a 4 per cent target and a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points while considering growth.

Answer: A. Explanation: The six-member MPC consists of the RBI Governor, the monetary-policy Deputy Governor, one RBI-nominated officer and three external members appointed by the Central Government, and decides the policy repo rate. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q26. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Monetary Policy Committee?

A. RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional body; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government and RBI performs monetary, currency, banking, reserve and payment functions. B. The six-member MPC consists of the RBI Governor, the monetary-policy Deputy Governor, one RBI-nominated officer and three external members appointed by the Central Government, and decides the policy repo rate. C. The 2022 SDF illustrates that RBI can absorb collateral-free surplus liquidity to align overnight rates without necessarily changing the repo-rate stance. D. MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags.

Answer: B. Explanation: The six-member MPC consists of the RBI Governor, the monetary-policy Deputy Governor, one RBI-nominated officer and three external members appointed by the Central Government, and decides the policy repo rate. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q27. Which statement uses Monetary Policy Committee without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags. B. During the pandemic RBI combined repo reductions with CRR easing, OMOs and targeted longer-term liquidity operations, showing that expansionary policy is an instrument package rather than a repo cut alone. C. The six-member MPC consists of the RBI Governor, the monetary-policy Deputy Governor, one RBI-nominated officer and three external members appointed by the Central Government, and decides the policy repo rate. D. The 2022 SDF illustrates that RBI can absorb collateral-free surplus liquidity to align overnight rates without necessarily changing the repo-rate stance.

Answer: C. Explanation: The six-member MPC consists of the RBI Governor, the monetary-policy Deputy Governor, one RBI-nominated officer and three external members appointed by the Central Government, and decides the policy repo rate. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q28. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Monetary Policy Committee?

A. During the pandemic RBI combined repo reductions with CRR easing, OMOs and targeted longer-term liquidity operations, showing that expansionary policy is an instrument package rather than a repo cut alone. B. The 2022 SDF illustrates that RBI can absorb collateral-free surplus liquidity to align overnight rates without necessarily changing the repo-rate stance. C. Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ. D. The six-member MPC consists of the RBI Governor, the monetary-policy Deputy Governor, one RBI-nominated officer and three external members appointed by the Central Government, and decides the policy repo rate.

Answer: D. Explanation: The six-member MPC consists of the RBI Governor, the monetary-policy Deputy Governor, one RBI-nominated officer and three external members appointed by the Central Government, and decides the policy repo rate. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Flexible inflation targeting?

A. India's framework uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a 4 per cent target and a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points while considering growth. B. The 2022 SDF illustrates that RBI can absorb collateral-free surplus liquidity to align overnight rates without necessarily changing the repo-rate stance. C. RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional body; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government and RBI performs monetary, currency, banking, reserve and payment functions. D. MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags.

Answer: A. Explanation: India's framework uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a 4 per cent target and a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points while considering growth. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q30. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Flexible inflation targeting?

A. During the pandemic RBI combined repo reductions with CRR easing, OMOs and targeted longer-term liquidity operations, showing that expansionary policy is an instrument package rather than a repo cut alone. B. India's framework uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a 4 per cent target and a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points while considering growth. C. The 2022 SDF illustrates that RBI can absorb collateral-free surplus liquidity to align overnight rates without necessarily changing the repo-rate stance. D. MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags.

Answer: B. Explanation: India's framework uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a 4 per cent target and a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points while considering growth. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q31. Which statement uses Flexible inflation targeting without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The 2022 SDF illustrates that RBI can absorb collateral-free surplus liquidity to align overnight rates without necessarily changing the repo-rate stance. B. During the pandemic RBI combined repo reductions with CRR easing, OMOs and targeted longer-term liquidity operations, showing that expansionary policy is an instrument package rather than a repo cut alone. C. India's framework uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a 4 per cent target and a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points while considering growth. D. Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ.

Answer: C. Explanation: India's framework uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a 4 per cent target and a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points while considering growth. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q32. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Flexible inflation targeting?

A. During the pandemic RBI combined repo reductions with CRR easing, OMOs and targeted longer-term liquidity operations, showing that expansionary policy is an instrument package rather than a repo cut alone. B. Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ. C. RBI may sell or buy foreign exchange to smooth excessive rupee volatility and offset the domestic-liquidity effect through OMOs or absorption operations; sterilisation does not imply a fixed exchange-rate promise. D. India's framework uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a 4 per cent target and a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points while considering growth.

Answer: D. Explanation: India's framework uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a 4 per cent target and a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points while considering growth. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Statutory RBI status?

A. RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional body; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government and RBI performs monetary, currency, banking, reserve and payment functions. B. During the pandemic RBI combined repo reductions with CRR easing, OMOs and targeted longer-term liquidity operations, showing that expansionary policy is an instrument package rather than a repo cut alone. C. The 2022 SDF illustrates that RBI can absorb collateral-free surplus liquidity to align overnight rates without necessarily changing the repo-rate stance. D. MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags.

Answer: A. Explanation: RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional body; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government and RBI performs monetary, currency, banking, reserve and payment functions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q34. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Statutory RBI status?

A. During the pandemic RBI combined repo reductions with CRR easing, OMOs and targeted longer-term liquidity operations, showing that expansionary policy is an instrument package rather than a repo cut alone. B. RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional body; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government and RBI performs monetary, currency, banking, reserve and payment functions. C. The 2022 SDF illustrates that RBI can absorb collateral-free surplus liquidity to align overnight rates without necessarily changing the repo-rate stance. D. Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ.

Answer: B. Explanation: RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional body; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government and RBI performs monetary, currency, banking, reserve and payment functions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q35. Which statement uses Statutory RBI status without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. RBI may sell or buy foreign exchange to smooth excessive rupee volatility and offset the domestic-liquidity effect through OMOs or absorption operations; sterilisation does not imply a fixed exchange-rate promise. B. During the pandemic RBI combined repo reductions with CRR easing, OMOs and targeted longer-term liquidity operations, showing that expansionary policy is an instrument package rather than a repo cut alone. C. RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional body; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government and RBI performs monetary, currency, banking, reserve and payment functions. D. Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because

funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ.

Answer: C. Explanation: RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional body; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government and RBI performs monetary, currency, banking, reserve and payment functions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q36. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Statutory RBI status?

A. Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ. B. RBI may sell or buy foreign exchange to smooth excessive rupee volatility and offset the domestic-liquidity effect through OMOs or absorption operations; sterilisation does not imply a fixed exchange-rate promise. C. OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance. D. RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional body; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government and RBI performs monetary, currency, banking, reserve and payment functions.

Answer: D. Explanation: RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional body; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government and RBI performs monetary, currency, banking, reserve and payment functions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Transmission chain?

A. MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags. B. During the pandemic RBI combined repo reductions with CRR easing, OMOs and targeted longer-term liquidity operations, showing that expansionary policy is an instrument package rather than a repo cut alone. C. The 2022 SDF illustrates that RBI can absorb collateral-free surplus liquidity to align overnight rates without necessarily changing the repo-rate stance. D. Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ.

Answer: A. Explanation: MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q38. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Transmission chain?

A. RBI may sell or buy foreign exchange to smooth excessive rupee volatility and offset the domestic-liquidity effect through OMOs or absorption operations; sterilisation does not imply a fixed exchange-rate promise. B. MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags. C. Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ. D. During the pandemic RBI combined repo reductions with CRR easing, OMOs and targeted longer-term liquidity operations, showing that expansionary policy is an instrument package rather than a repo cut alone.

Answer: B. Explanation: MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q39. Which statement uses Transmission chain without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance. B. RBI may sell or buy foreign exchange to smooth excessive rupee volatility and offset the domestic-liquidity effect through OMOs or absorption operations; sterilisation does not imply a fixed exchange-rate promise. C. MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags. D. Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ.

Answer: C. Explanation: MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q40. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Transmission chain?

A. Legal tender must be accepted in settlement within the legal framework, and Indian currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet rather than RBI income. B. OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance. C. RBI may sell or buy foreign exchange to smooth excessive rupee volatility and offset the domestic-liquidity effect through OMOs or absorption operations; sterilisation does not imply a fixed exchange-rate promise. D. MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags.

Answer: D. Explanation: MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies SDF-liquidity distinction?

A. The 2022 SDF illustrates that RBI can absorb collateral-free surplus liquidity to align overnight rates without necessarily changing the repo-rate stance. B. Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ. C. During the pandemic RBI combined repo reductions with CRR easing, OMOs and targeted longer-term liquidity operations, showing that expansionary policy is an instrument package rather than a repo cut alone. D. RBI may sell or buy foreign exchange to smooth excessive rupee volatility and offset the domestic-liquidity effect through OMOs or absorption operations; sterilisation does not imply a fixed exchange-rate promise.

Answer: A. Explanation: The 2022 SDF illustrates that RBI can absorb collateral-free surplus liquidity to align overnight rates without necessarily changing the repo-rate stance. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q42. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of SDF-liquidity distinction?

A. OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance. B. The 2022 SDF illustrates that RBI can absorb collateral-free surplus liquidity to align overnight rates without necessarily changing the repo-rate stance. C. Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ. D. RBI may sell or buy foreign exchange to smooth excessive rupee volatility and offset the domestic-liquidity effect through OMOs or absorption operations; sterilisation does not imply a fixed exchange-rate promise.

Answer: B. Explanation: The 2022 SDF illustrates that RBI can absorb collateral-free surplus liquidity to align overnight rates without necessarily changing the repo-rate stance. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q43. Which statement uses SDF-liquidity distinction without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance. B. Legal tender must be accepted in settlement within the legal framework, and Indian currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet rather than RBI income. C. The 2022 SDF illustrates that RBI can absorb collateral-free surplus liquidity to align overnight rates without necessarily changing the repo-rate stance. D. RBI may sell or buy foreign exchange to smooth excessive rupee volatility and offset the domestic-liquidity effect through OMOs or absorption operations; sterilisation does not imply a fixed exchange-rate promise.

Answer: C. Explanation: The 2022 SDF illustrates that RBI can absorb collateral-free surplus liquidity to align overnight rates without necessarily changing the repo-rate stance. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q44. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about SDF-liquidity distinction?

A. Reserve money supports broader money creation through banking; lower reserve impounding and currency leakage and greater willingness to lend generally raise the money multiplier. B. OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance. C. Legal tender must be accepted in settlement within the legal framework, and Indian currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet rather than RBI income. D. The 2022 SDF illustrates that RBI can absorb collateral-free surplus liquidity to align overnight rates without necessarily changing the repo-rate stance.

Answer: D. Explanation: The 2022 SDF illustrates that RBI can absorb collateral-free surplus liquidity to align overnight rates without necessarily changing the repo-rate stance. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Pandemic policy package?

A. During the pandemic RBI combined repo reductions with CRR easing, OMOs and targeted longer-term liquidity operations, showing that expansionary policy is an instrument package rather than a repo cut alone. B. OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance. C. Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ. D. RBI may sell or buy foreign exchange to smooth excessive rupee volatility and offset the domestic-liquidity effect through OMOs or absorption operations; sterilisation does not imply a fixed exchange-rate promise.

Answer: A. Explanation: During the pandemic RBI combined repo reductions with CRR easing, OMOs and targeted longer-term liquidity operations, showing that expansionary policy is an instrument package rather than a repo cut alone. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q46. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Pandemic policy package?

A. RBI may sell or buy foreign exchange to smooth excessive rupee volatility and offset the domestic-liquidity effect through OMOs or absorption operations; sterilisation does not imply a fixed exchange-rate promise. B. During the pandemic RBI combined repo reductions with CRR easing, OMOs and targeted longer-term liquidity operations, showing that expansionary policy is an instrument package rather than a repo cut alone. C. OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance. D. Legal tender must be accepted in settlement within the legal framework, and Indian currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet rather than RBI income.

Answer: B. Explanation: During the pandemic RBI combined repo reductions with CRR easing, OMOs and targeted longer-term liquidity operations, showing that expansionary policy is an instrument package rather than a repo cut alone. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments,

Q47. Which statement uses Pandemic policy package without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance. B. Legal tender must be accepted in settlement within the legal framework, and Indian currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet rather than RBI income. C. During the pandemic RBI combined repo reductions with CRR easing, OMOs and targeted longer-term liquidity operations, showing that expansionary policy is an instrument package rather than a repo cut alone. D. Reserve money supports broader money creation through banking; lower reserve impounding and currency leakage and greater willingness to lend generally raise the money multiplier.

Answer: C. Explanation: During the pandemic RBI combined repo reductions with CRR easing, OMOs and targeted longer-term liquidity operations, showing that expansionary policy is an instrument package rather than a repo cut alone. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q48. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Pandemic policy package?

A. Reserve money supports broader money creation through banking; lower reserve impounding and currency leakage and greater willingness to lend generally raise the money multiplier. B. Legal tender must be accepted in settlement within the legal framework, and Indian currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet rather than RBI income. C. RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from banking and market functions. D. During the pandemic RBI combined repo reductions with CRR easing, OMOs and targeted longer-term liquidity operations, showing that expansionary policy is an instrument package rather than a repo cut alone.

Answer: D. Explanation: During the pandemic RBI combined repo reductions with CRR easing, OMOs and targeted longer-term liquidity operations, showing that expansionary policy is an instrument package rather than a repo cut alone. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Uneven pass-through?

A. Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ. B. OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance. C. Legal tender must be accepted in settlement within the legal framework, and Indian currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet rather than RBI income. D. RBI may sell or buy foreign exchange to smooth excessive rupee volatility and offset the domestic-liquidity effect through OMOs or absorption operations; sterilisation does not imply a fixed exchange-rate promise.

Answer: A. Explanation: Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q50. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Uneven pass-through?

A. Reserve money supports broader money creation through banking; lower reserve impounding and currency leakage and greater willingness to lend generally raise the money multiplier. B. Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ. C. Legal tender must be accepted in settlement within the legal framework, and Indian currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet rather than RBI income. D. OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance.

Answer: B. Explanation: Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q51. Which statement uses Uneven pass-through without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Legal tender must be accepted in settlement within the legal framework, and Indian currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet rather than RBI income. B. RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from banking and market functions. C. Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ. D. Reserve money supports broader money creation through banking; lower reserve impounding and currency leakage and greater willingness to lend generally raise the money multiplier.

Answer: C. Explanation: Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q52. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Uneven pass-through?

A. RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a regulated payments direction, not a universal data-localisation law. B. RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from banking and market functions. C. Reserve money supports broader money creation through banking; lower reserve impounding and currency leakage and greater willingness to lend generally raise the money multiplier. D. Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ.

Answer: D. Explanation: Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Forex intervention and sterilisation?

A. RBI may sell or buy foreign exchange to smooth excessive rupee volatility and offset the domestic-liquidity effect through OMOs or absorption operations; sterilisation does not imply a fixed exchange-rate promise. B. Reserve money supports broader money creation through banking; lower reserve impounding and currency leakage and greater willingness to lend generally raise the money multiplier. C. OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance. D. Legal tender must be accepted in settlement within the legal framework, and Indian currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet rather than RBI income.

Answer: A. Explanation: RBI may sell or buy foreign exchange to smooth excessive rupee volatility and offset the domestic-liquidity effect through OMOs or absorption operations; sterilisation does not imply a fixed exchange-rate promise. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q54. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Forex intervention and sterilisation?

A. Reserve money supports broader money creation through banking; lower reserve impounding and currency leakage and greater willingness to lend generally raise the money multiplier. B. RBI may sell or buy foreign exchange to smooth excessive rupee volatility and offset the domestic-liquidity effect through OMOs or absorption operations; sterilisation does not imply a fixed exchange-rate promise. C. RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from banking and market functions. D. Legal tender must be accepted in settlement within the legal framework, and Indian currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet rather than RBI income.

Answer: B. Explanation: RBI may sell or buy foreign exchange to smooth excessive rupee volatility and offset the domestic-liquidity effect through OMOs or absorption operations; sterilisation does not imply a fixed exchange-rate promise. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q55. Which statement uses Forex intervention and sterilisation without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from banking and market functions. B. Reserve money supports broader money creation through banking; lower reserve impounding and currency leakage and greater willingness to lend generally raise the money multiplier. C. RBI may sell or buy foreign exchange to smooth excessive rupee volatility and offset the domestic-liquidity effect through OMOs or absorption operations; sterilisation does not imply a fixed exchange-rate promise. D. RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a regulated payments direction, not a universal data-localisation law.

Answer: C. Explanation: RBI may sell or buy foreign exchange to smooth excessive rupee volatility and offset the domestic-liquidity effect through OMOs or absorption operations; sterilisation does not imply a fixed exchange-rate promise. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q56. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Forex intervention and sterilisation?

A. RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from banking and market functions. B. RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a regulated payments direction, not a universal data-localisation law. C. The Hilton-Young Commission concerns colonial currency and central-banking reform, Narasimham Committees concern Government of India banking reform, and the Tarapore Committee concerns RBI work on capital-account convertibility. D. RBI may sell or buy foreign exchange to smooth excessive rupee volatility and offset the domestic-liquidity effect through OMOs or absorption operations; sterilisation does not imply a fixed exchange-rate promise.

Answer: D. Explanation: RBI may sell or buy foreign exchange to smooth excessive rupee volatility and offset the domestic-liquidity effect through OMOs or absorption operations; sterilisation does not imply a fixed exchange-rate promise. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies OMO and yield conditions?

A. OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance. B. RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from banking and market functions. C. Legal tender must be accepted in settlement within the legal framework, and Indian currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet rather than RBI income. D. Reserve money supports broader money creation through banking; lower reserve impounding and currency leakage and greater willingness to lend generally raise the money multiplier.

Answer: A. Explanation: OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q58. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of OMO and yield conditions?

A. Reserve money supports broader money creation through banking; lower reserve impounding and currency leakage and greater willingness to lend generally raise the money multiplier. B. OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance. C. RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a regulated payments direction, not a universal data-localisation law. D. RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from banking and market functions.

Answer: B. Explanation: OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q59. Which statement uses OMO and yield conditions without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a regulated payments direction, not a universal data-localisation law. B. RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from banking and market functions. C. OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance. D. The Hilton-Young Commission concerns colonial currency and central-banking reform, Narasimham Committees concern Government of India banking reform, and the Tarapore Committee concerns RBI work on capital-account convertibility.

Answer: C. Explanation: OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q60. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about OMO and yield conditions?

A. RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a regulated payments direction, not a universal data-localisation law. B. The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection. C. The Hilton-Young Commission concerns colonial currency and central-banking reform, Narasimham Committees concern Government of India banking reform, and the Tarapore Committee concerns RBI work on capital-account convertibility. D. OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance.

Answer: D. Explanation: OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Legal tender and RBI liabilities?

A. Legal tender must be accepted in settlement within the legal framework, and Indian currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet rather than RBI income. B. Reserve money supports broader money creation through banking; lower reserve impounding and currency leakage and greater willingness to lend generally raise the money multiplier. C. RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from banking and market functions. D. RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a regulated payments direction, not a universal data-localisation law.

Answer: A. Explanation: Legal tender must be accepted in settlement within the legal framework, and Indian currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet rather than RBI income. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q62. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Legal tender and RBI liabilities?

A. RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a regulated payments direction, not a universal data-localisation law. B. Legal tender must be accepted in settlement within the legal framework, and Indian currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet rather than RBI income. C. RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from banking and market functions. D. The Hilton-Young Commission concerns colonial currency and central-banking reform, Narasimham Committees concern Government of India banking reform, and the Tarapore Committee concerns RBI work on capital-account convertibility.

Answer: B. Explanation: Legal tender must be accepted in settlement within the legal framework, and Indian currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet rather than RBI income. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q63. Which statement uses Legal tender and RBI liabilities without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection. B. RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a regulated payments direction, not a universal data-localisation law. C. Legal tender must be accepted in settlement within the legal framework, and Indian currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet rather than RBI income. D. The Hilton-Young Commission concerns colonial currency and central-banking reform, Narasimham Committees concern Government of India banking reform, and the Tarapore Committee concerns RBI work on capital-account convertibility.

Answer: C. Explanation: Legal tender must be accepted in settlement within the legal framework, and Indian currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet rather than RBI income. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q64. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Legal tender and RBI liabilities?

A. The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022. B. The Hilton-Young Commission concerns colonial currency and central-banking reform, Narasimham Committees concern Government of India banking reform, and the Tarapore Committee concerns RBI work on capital-account convertibility. C. The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection. D. Legal tender must be accepted in settlement within the legal framework, and Indian currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet rather than RBI income.

Answer: D. Explanation: Legal tender must be accepted in settlement within the legal framework, and Indian currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet rather than RBI income. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Money multiplier?

A. Reserve money supports broader money creation through banking; lower reserve impounding and currency leakage and greater willingness to lend generally raise the money multiplier. B. RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a regulated payments direction, not a universal data-localisation law. C. The Hilton-Young Commission concerns colonial currency and central-banking reform, Narasimham Committees concern Government of India banking reform, and the Tarapore Committee concerns RBI work on capital-account convertibility. D. RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from banking and market functions.

Answer: A. Explanation: Reserve money supports broader money creation through banking; lower reserve impounding and currency leakage and greater willingness to lend generally raise the money multiplier. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q66. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Money multiplier?

A. RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a regulated payments direction, not a universal data-localisation law. B. Reserve money supports broader money creation through banking; lower reserve impounding and currency leakage and greater willingness to lend generally raise the money multiplier. C. The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection. D. The Hilton-Young Commission concerns colonial currency and central-banking reform, Narasimham Committees concern Government of India banking reform, and the Tarapore Committee concerns RBI work on capital-account convertibility.

Answer: B. Explanation: Reserve money supports broader money creation through banking; lower reserve impounding and currency leakage and greater willingness to lend generally raise the money multiplier. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q67. Which statement uses Money multiplier without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022. B. The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection. C. Reserve money supports broader money creation through banking; lower reserve impounding and currency leakage and greater willingness to lend generally raise the money multiplier. D. The Hilton-Young Commission concerns colonial currency and central-banking reform, Narasimham Committees concern Government of India banking reform, and the Tarapore Committee concerns RBI work on capital-account convertibility.

Answer: C. Explanation: Reserve money supports broader money creation through banking; lower reserve impounding and currency leakage and greater willingness to lend generally raise the money multiplier. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Money multiplier?

A. MSF is an overnight backstop borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities; its counterparty and emergency role differ from ordinary repo operations. B. The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection. C. The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022. D. Reserve money supports broader money creation through banking; lower reserve impounding and currency leakage and greater willingness to lend generally raise the money multiplier.

Answer: D. Explanation: Reserve money supports broader money creation through banking; lower reserve impounding and currency leakage and greater willingness to lend generally raise the money multiplier. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies RBI income sources?

A. RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from banking and market functions. B. The Hilton-Young Commission concerns colonial currency and central-banking reform, Narasimham Committees concern Government of India banking reform, and the Tarapore Committee concerns RBI work on capital-account convertibility. C. The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection. D. RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a regulated payments direction, not a universal data-localisation law.

Answer: A. Explanation: RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from banking and market functions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q70. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of RBI income sources?

A. The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection. B. RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from banking and market functions. C. The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022. D. The Hilton-Young Commission concerns colonial currency and central-banking reform, Narasimham Committees concern Government of India banking reform, and the Tarapore Committee concerns RBI work on capital-account convertibility.

Answer: B. Explanation: RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from banking and market functions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q71. Which statement uses RBI income sources without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection. B. MSF is an overnight backstop borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities; its counterparty and emergency role differ from ordinary repo operations. C. RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from banking and market functions. D. The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022.

Answer: C. Explanation: RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from banking and market functions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q72. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about RBI income sources?

A. MSF is an overnight backstop borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities; its counterparty and emergency role differ from ordinary repo operations. B. The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022. C. CRR is the share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI, broadly impounding bank resources and affecting lendable funds. D. RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from banking and market functions.

Answer: D. Explanation: RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from banking and market functions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal

perimeters.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Payment-data direction?

A. RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a regulated payments direction, not a universal data-localisation law. B. The Hilton-Young Commission concerns colonial currency and central-banking reform, Narasimham Committees concern Government of India banking reform, and the Tarapore Committee concerns RBI work on capital-account convertibility. C. The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022. D. The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection.

Answer: A. Explanation: RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a regulated payments direction, not a universal data-localisation law. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q74. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Payment-data direction?

A. The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022. B. RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a regulated payments direction, not a universal data-localisation law. C. The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection. D. MSF is an overnight backstop borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities; its counterparty and emergency role differ from ordinary repo operations.

Answer: B. Explanation: RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a regulated payments direction, not a universal data-localisation law. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q75. Which statement uses Payment-data direction without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022. B. CRR is the share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI, broadly impounding bank resources and affecting lendable funds. C. RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a regulated payments direction, not a universal data-localisation law. D. MSF is an overnight backstop borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities; its counterparty and emergency role differ from ordinary repo operations.

Answer: C. Explanation: RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a regulated payments direction, not a universal data-localisation law. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Payment-data direction?

A. CRR is the share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI, broadly impounding bank resources and affecting lendable funds. B. MSF is an overnight backstop borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities; its counterparty and emergency role differ from ordinary repo operations. C. OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions. D. RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a regulated payments direction, not a universal data-localisation law.

Answer: D. Explanation: RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a regulated payments direction, not a universal data-localisation law. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal

perimeters.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Committee-institution pairs?

A. The Hilton-Young Commission concerns colonial currency and central-banking reform, Narasimham Committees concern Government of India banking reform, and the Tarapore Committee concerns RBI work on capital-account convertibility. B. The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022. C. The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection. D. MSF is an overnight backstop borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities; its counterparty and emergency role differ from ordinary repo operations.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Hilton-Young Commission concerns colonial currency and central-banking reform, Narasimham Committees concern Government of India banking reform, and the Tarapore Committee concerns RBI work on capital-account convertibility. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q78. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Committee-institution pairs?

A. The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022. B. The Hilton-Young Commission concerns colonial currency and central-banking reform, Narasimham Committees concern Government of India banking reform, and the Tarapore Committee concerns RBI work on capital-account convertibility. C. CRR is the share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI, broadly impounding bank resources and affecting lendable funds. D. MSF is an overnight backstop borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities; its counterparty and emergency role differ from ordinary repo operations.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Hilton-Young Commission concerns colonial currency and central-banking reform, Narasimham Committees concern Government of India banking reform, and the Tarapore Committee concerns RBI work on capital-account convertibility. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q79. Which statement uses Committee-institution pairs without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. CRR is the share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI, broadly impounding bank resources and affecting lendable funds. B. OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions. C. The Hilton-Young Commission concerns colonial currency and central-banking reform, Narasimham Committees concern Government of India banking reform, and the Tarapore Committee concerns RBI work on capital-account convertibility. D. MSF is an overnight backstop borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities; its counterparty and emergency role differ from ordinary repo operations.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Hilton-Young Commission concerns colonial currency and central-banking reform, Narasimham Committees concern Government of India banking reform, and the Tarapore Committee concerns RBI work on capital-account convertibility. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Committee-institution pairs?

A. CRR is the share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI, broadly impounding bank resources and affecting lendable funds. B. OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions. C. The weighted average call rate is the operating target that RBI liquidity operations seek to align with the policy corridor; the policy target, repo rate and operating target are distinct. D. The Hilton-Young Commission concerns colonial currency and central-banking reform, Narasimham Committees concern Government of India banking reform, and the Tarapore Committee concerns RBI work on capital-account convertibility.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Hilton-Young Commission concerns colonial currency and central-banking reform, Narasimham Committees concern Government of India banking reform, and the Tarapore Committee concerns RBI work on capital-account convertibility. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED OBJECTIVE-ONLY PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

This Basic owner carries audited objective routes on legal tender, rupee management, payment-data storage, the money multiplier, expansionary instruments, RBI status, lender of last resort, interest-rate hikes, sterilisation, RBI income and reform committees. No routed Mains demand is manufactured and no unavailable or provisional objective answer is inferred.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: 2025 Prelims tested RBI income sources: government securities and foreign-currency operations.

- ANALYSIS: 2024 Prelims tested that NBFCs do not broadly enjoy direct LAF access.

- FACT: **2026 Prelims Q2 (official provisional key):** tested why the

Hilton-Young Commission's fixed rupee-sterling rate aided British remittances and India's creditworthiness. This is monetary history, not an MPC instrument. Exact route: `../README.md`.

2026 PYQ Integration

Status: 2026 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: `_PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2026.md`. **Answer-key rule:** The 2026 Prelims and CSAT Set-A keys held locally are **provisional**; no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Year represented:** 2026

- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I

- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2026	Prelims GS-I	98	Indian financial-sector reform committees and their institutional sponsors	Objective question; provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally, answer not inferred	Provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally (Ans - 2026-GS1-Provisional); key is provisional - no answer letter recorded or inferred here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Indian financial-sector reform committees and their institutional sponsors

This block integrates the 2026 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 blocks and does not convert a provisionally-keyed, answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: `_PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2024-2025.md`. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2024-2025 Prelims Set-A keys are present in the repository and CSAT Set-A keys are supplied; even so, no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Years represented:** 2025

- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2025	Prelims GS-I	2	Sources of income of the Reserve Bank of India	Objective question; official Set-A key available locally, answer not inferred	Key available locally (official Set-A answer key present); answer not recorded here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Sources of income of the Reserve Bank of India

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 12

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	Prelims GS-I	46	Legal tender money definition and characteristics	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2019	Prelims GS-I	86	Government and RBI measures to prevent rupee depreciation	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2019	Prelims GS-I	87	RBI payment data storage directive for system providers	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2019	Prelims GS-I	90	Conditions that increase money multiplier in economy	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2020	Prelims GS-I	57	RBI expansionist monetary policy instruments and actions	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2021	Prelims GS-I	1	RBI Governor appointment and constitutional powers	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Monetary-policy specialist plus statutory-not-constitutional regulator classification; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2021	Prelims GS-I	11	Money multiplier and reserve ratios in banking	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2021	Prelims GS-I	15	Central bank lender of last resort function	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2022	Prelims GS-I	3	RBI monetary policy tools and rupee management	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2022	Prelims GS-I	68	Institution responsible for price stability and inflation control	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2023	Prelims GS-I	22	Central banks interest rate hikes post-pandemic monetary policy	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2023	Prelims GS-I	24	RBI sterilization and Open Market Operations role	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Legal tender money definition and characteristics
- Government and RBI measures to prevent rupee depreciation
- RBI payment data storage directive for system providers
- Conditions that increase money multiplier in economy

- RBI expansionist monetary policy instruments and actions
- RBI Governor appointment and constitutional powers
- Money multiplier and reserve ratios in banking
- Central bank lender of last resort function
- RBI monetary policy tools and rupee management
- Institution responsible for price stability and inflation control
- Central banks interest rate hikes post-pandemic monetary policy
- RBI sterilization and Open Market Operations role

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: 2025 Prelims tested RBI income sources: government securities and foreign-currency operations.

- ANALYSIS: 2024 Prelims tested that NBFCs do not broadly enjoy direct LAF access.

- FACT: **2026 Prelims Q2 (official provisional key):** Hilton-Young

Commission, fixed rupee-sterling rate, British remittances and external creditworthiness. Keep the provisional label; see . . /README . md.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Why is liquidity management necessary after an MPC repo-rate decision? Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Repo-rate signal. **Named evidence/example:** The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Standing Deposit Facility. **Named evidence/example:** The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** WACR operating target. **Named evidence/example:** The weighted average call rate is the operating target that RBI liquidity operations seek to align with the policy corridor; the policy target, repo rate and operating target are distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection.
- The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022.
- The weighted average call rate is the operating target that RBI liquidity operations seek to align with the policy corridor; the policy target, repo rate and operating target are distinct.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Repo-rate signal. **Named evidence/example:** The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise

beyond the source. **Claim:** Standing Deposit Facility. **Named evidence/example:** The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022.

Analysis: This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** WACR operating target. **Named evidence/example:** The weighted average call rate is the operating target that RBI liquidity operations seek to align with the policy corridor; the policy target, repo rate and operating target are distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Why is liquidity management necessary after an MPC repo-rate decision? Answer in about 150...", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Repo-rate signal. **Named evidence/example:** The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Standing Deposit Facility. **Named evidence/example:** The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** WACR operating target. **Named evidence/example:** The weighted average call rate is the operating target that RBI liquidity operations seek to align with the policy corridor; the policy target, repo rate and operating target are distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The weighted average call rate is the operating target that RBI liquidity operations seek to align with the policy corridor; the policy target, repo rate and operating target are distinct. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional

benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Repo-rate signal. **Named evidence/example:** The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Standing Deposit Facility. **Named evidence/example:** The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** WACR operating target. **Named evidence/example:** The weighted average call rate is the operating target that RBI liquidity operations seek to align with the policy corridor; the policy target, repo rate and operating target are distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Why is liquidity management necessary after an MPC repo-rate decision? Answer in about 150...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish repo, SDF, MSF, CRR and OMO. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Repo-rate signal. **Named evidence/example:** The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Standing Deposit Facility. **Named evidence/example:** The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Marginal Standing Facility. **Named evidence/example:** MSF is an overnight backstop borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities; its counterparty and emergency role differ from ordinary repo operations. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Cash Reserve Ratio. **Named evidence/example:** CRR is the share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI, broadly impounding bank resources and affecting lendable funds. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Open Market Operations.

Named evidence/example: OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection.
- The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022.
- MSF is an overnight backstop borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities; its counterparty and emergency role differ from ordinary repo operations.
- CRR is the share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI, broadly impounding bank resources and affecting lendable funds.
- OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Repo-rate signal. **Named evidence/example:** The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Standing Deposit Facility. **Named evidence/example:** The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Marginal Standing Facility. **Named evidence/example:** MSF is an overnight backstop borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities; its counterparty and emergency role differ from ordinary repo operations. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Cash Reserve Ratio. **Named evidence/example:** CRR is the share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI, broadly impounding bank resources and affecting lendable funds. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Open Market Operations. **Named evidence/example:** OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Distinguish repo, SDF, MSF, CRR and OMO. Answer in about 150 words.", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Repo-rate signal. **Named evidence/example:** The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise

beyond the source. **Claim:** Standing Deposit Facility. **Named evidence/example:** The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022.

Analysis: This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:**

Marginal Standing Facility. **Named evidence/example:** MSF is an overnight backstop borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities; its counterparty and emergency role differ from ordinary repo operations. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated

period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Cash Reserve Ratio. **Named evidence/example:** CRR is the share of net demand and time liabilities

maintained as cash with RBI, broadly impounding bank resources and affecting lendable funds. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Open Market

Operations. **Named evidence/example:** OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** MSF is an overnight backstop borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities; its counterparty and emergency role differ from ordinary repo operations. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** CRR is the share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI, broadly impounding bank resources and affecting lendable funds. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Repo-rate signal. **Named evidence/example:** The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Standing Deposit Facility. **Named evidence/example:** The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Marginal Standing Facility. **Named evidence/example:** MSF is an overnight backstop borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities; its counterparty and emergency role differ from ordinary repo operations. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Cash Reserve Ratio. **Named evidence/example:** CRR is the share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI, broadly impounding bank resources and affecting lendable funds. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Open Market Operations. **Named evidence/example:** OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Distinguish repo, SDF, MSF, CRR and OMO. Answer in about 150 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Explain India's monetary-policy transmission chain and its frictions. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Transmission chain. **Named evidence/example:** MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Uneven pass-through. **Named evidence/example:** Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** OMO and yield conditions. **Named evidence/example:** OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags.
- Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ.
- OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Transmission chain. **Named evidence/example:** MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Uneven pass-through. **Named evidence/example:** Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** OMO and yield conditions. **Named evidence/example:** OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain India's monetary-policy transmission chain and its frictions. Answer in about 250...", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Transmission chain. **Named evidence/example:** MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Uneven pass-through. **Named evidence/example:** Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** OMO and yield conditions. **Named evidence/example:** OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Transmission chain. **Named evidence/example:** MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Uneven pass-through. **Named evidence/example:** Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** OMO and yield conditions. **Named evidence/example:** OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain India's monetary-policy transmission chain and its frictions. Answer in about 250...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and

qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Assess the role of OMOs and sterilisation in liquidity and external management. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Open Market Operations. **Named evidence/example:** OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Forex intervention and sterilisation. **Named evidence/example:** RBI may sell or buy foreign exchange to smooth excessive rupee volatility and offset the domestic-liquidity effect through OMOs or absorption operations; sterilisation does not imply a fixed exchange-rate promise. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** OMO and yield conditions. **Named evidence/example:** OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions.
- RBI may sell or buy foreign exchange to smooth excessive rupee volatility and offset the domestic-liquidity effect through OMOs or absorption operations; sterilisation does not imply a fixed exchange-rate promise.
- OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Open Market Operations. **Named evidence/example:** OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Forex intervention and sterilisation. **Named evidence/example:** RBI may sell or buy foreign exchange to smooth excessive rupee volatility and offset the domestic-liquidity effect through OMOs or absorption operations; sterilisation does not imply a fixed exchange-rate promise. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** OMO and yield conditions. **Named evidence/example:** OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess the role of OMOs and sterilisation in liquidity and external management. Answer in...", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Open Market Operations. **Named evidence/example:** OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond

overnight cash conditions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Forex intervention and sterilisation. **Named evidence/example:** RBI may sell or buy foreign exchange to smooth excessive rupee volatility and offset the domestic-liquidity effect through OMOs or absorption operations; sterilisation does not imply a fixed exchange-rate promise. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** OMO and yield conditions. **Named evidence/example:** OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** RBI may sell or buy foreign exchange to smooth excessive rupee volatility and offset the domestic-liquidity effect through OMOs or absorption operations; sterilisation does not imply a fixed exchange-rate promise. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Open Market Operations. **Named evidence/example:** OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Forex intervention and sterilisation. **Named evidence/example:** RBI may sell or buy foreign exchange to smooth excessive rupee volatility and offset the domestic-liquidity effect through OMOs or absorption operations; sterilisation does not imply a fixed exchange-rate promise. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** OMO and yield conditions. **Named evidence/example:** OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base

year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess the role of OMOs and sterilisation in liquidity and external management. Answer in...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Critically evaluate India's flexible inflation-targeting and MPC framework. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Monetary Policy Committee. **Named evidence/example:** The six-member MPC consists of the RBI Governor, the monetary-policy Deputy Governor, one RBI-nominated officer and three external members appointed by the Central Government, and decides the policy repo rate. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Flexible inflation targeting. **Named evidence/example:** India's framework uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a 4 per cent target and a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points while considering growth. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Transmission chain. **Named evidence/example:** MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Uneven pass-through. **Named evidence/example:** Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The six-member MPC consists of the RBI Governor, the monetary-policy Deputy Governor, one RBI-nominated officer and three external members appointed by the Central Government, and decides the policy repo rate.
- India's framework uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a 4 per cent target and a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points while considering growth.
- MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags.
- Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Monetary Policy Committee. **Named evidence/example:** The six-member MPC consists of the RBI Governor, the monetary-policy Deputy Governor, one RBI-nominated officer and three external members appointed by the Central Government, and decides the policy repo rate. **Analysis:** This identifies the

economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Flexible inflation targeting. **Named evidence/example:** India's framework uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a 4 per cent target and a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points while considering growth. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Transmission chain. **Named evidence/example:** MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Uneven pass-through. **Named evidence/example:** Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **evaluate** requires a direct position on "Critically evaluate India's flexible inflation-targeting and MPC framework. Answer in about...", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Monetary Policy Committee. **Named evidence/example:** The six-member MPC consists of the RBI Governor, the monetary-policy Deputy Governor, one RBI-nominated officer and three external members appointed by the Central Government, and decides the policy repo rate. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Flexible inflation targeting. **Named evidence/example:** India's framework uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a 4 per cent target and a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points while considering growth. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Transmission chain. **Named evidence/example:** MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Uneven pass-through. **Named evidence/example:** Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The six-member MPC consists of the RBI Governor, the monetary-policy Deputy Governor, one RBI-nominated officer and three external members appointed by the Central Government, and decides the policy repo rate. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority

and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** India's framework uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a 4 per cent target and a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points while considering growth. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect.

Qualification: State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect.

Qualification: State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Monetary Policy Committee. **Named evidence/example:** The six-member MPC consists of the RBI Governor, the monetary-policy Deputy Governor, one RBI-nominated officer and three external members appointed by the Central Government, and decides the policy repo rate. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Flexible inflation targeting.

Named evidence/example: India's framework uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a 4 per cent target and a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points while considering growth. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Transmission chain. **Named evidence/example:** MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Uneven pass-through.

Named evidence/example: Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Critically evaluate India's flexible inflation-targeting and MPC framework. Answer in about...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Analyse RBI's monetary, liquidity, currency and payment functions with their legal boundaries. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Statutory RBI status. **Named evidence/example:** RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional body; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government and RBI performs monetary, currency, banking, reserve and payment functions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Legal tender and RBI liabilities. **Named evidence/example:** Legal tender must be accepted in settlement within the legal framework, and Indian currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet rather than RBI income. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** RBI income sources. **Named evidence/example:** RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from banking and market functions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Payment-data direction. **Named evidence/example:** RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a regulated payments direction, not a universal data-localisation law. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Committee-institution pairs. **Named evidence/example:** The Hilton-Young Commission concerns colonial currency and central-banking reform, Narasimham Committees concern Government of India banking reform, and the Tarapore Committee concerns RBI work on capital-account convertibility. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional body; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government and RBI performs monetary, currency, banking, reserve and payment functions.
- Legal tender must be accepted in settlement within the legal framework, and Indian currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet rather than RBI income.
- RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from banking and market functions.
- RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a regulated payments direction, not a universal data-localisation law.
- The Hilton-Young Commission concerns colonial currency and central-banking reform, Narasimham Committees concern Government of India banking reform, and the Tarapore Committee concerns RBI work on capital-account convertibility.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Statutory RBI status. **Named evidence/example:** RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional body; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government and RBI performs monetary,

currency, banking, reserve and payment functions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Legal tender and RBI liabilities. **Named evidence/example:** Legal tender must be accepted in settlement within the legal framework, and Indian currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet rather than RBI income. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** RBI income sources. **Named evidence/example:** RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from banking and market functions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Payment-data direction. **Named evidence/example:** RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a regulated payments direction, not a universal data-localisation law. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Committee-institution pairs. **Named evidence/example:** The Hilton-Young Commission concerns colonial currency and central-banking reform, Narasimham Committees concern Government of India banking reform, and the Tarapore Committee concerns RBI work on capital-account convertibility. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **analyse** requires a direct position on "Analyse RBI's monetary, liquidity, currency and payment functions with their legal...", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Statutory RBI status. **Named evidence/example:** RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional body; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government and RBI performs monetary, currency, banking, reserve and payment functions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Legal tender and RBI liabilities. **Named evidence/example:** Legal tender must be accepted in settlement within the legal framework, and Indian currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet rather than RBI income. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** RBI income sources. **Named evidence/example:** RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from banking and market functions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Payment-data direction. **Named evidence/example:** RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a regulated payments direction, not a universal data-localisation law. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Committee-institution pairs. **Named evidence/example:** The Hilton-Young Commission concerns colonial currency

and central-banking reform, Narasimham Committees concern Government of India banking reform, and the Tarapore Committee concerns RBI work on capital-account convertibility. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional body; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government and RBI performs monetary, currency, banking, reserve and payment functions. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Legal tender must be accepted in settlement within the legal framework, and Indian currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet rather than RBI income. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from banking and market functions. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a regulated payments direction, not a universal data-localisation law. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** The Hilton-Young Commission concerns colonial currency and central-banking reform, Narasimham Committees concern Government of India banking reform, and the Tarapore Committee concerns RBI work on capital-account convertibility. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Statutory RBI status. **Named evidence/example:** RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional body; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government and RBI performs monetary, currency, banking, reserve and payment functions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Legal tender and RBI liabilities. **Named evidence/example:** Legal tender must be accepted in settlement within the legal framework, and Indian currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet rather than RBI income. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter

rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** RBI income sources. **Named evidence/example:** RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from banking and market functions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Payment-data direction. **Named**

evidence/example: RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a regulated payments direction, not a universal data-localisation law. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:**

Committee-institution pairs. **Named evidence/example:** The Hilton-Young Commission concerns colonial currency and central-banking reform, Narasimham Committees concern Government of India banking reform, and the Tarapore Committee concerns RBI work on capital-account convertibility. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Analyse RBI's monetary, liquidity, currency and payment functions with their legal...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Subject: Economy | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** GS-III + Prelims. **Core area:** Monetary policy. **Grounded in:** Ramesh Singh, relevant chapters; Economic Survey 2025-26; audited UPSC Economy PYQs (2024-2026 Prelims and 2024-2025 Mains). **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = inference/analysis | **CURRENT:** = current Survey/current-affairs hook. *Companion:*
../basic/04_RBI-Monetary-Policy-and-Liquidity-Management.md.

1. Architecture

1. MPC policy signal
|
v
2. money-market rates
|
v
3. bank funding and deposit rates
|
v
4. lending rates and asset prices
|
v
5. demand, output and inflation

Analytical claim: Separate the policy-rate signal from liquidity implementation and then trace pass-through through markets, banks, borrowers and expectations.

2. Concepts and distinctions

Concept	Precise meaning
FACT: Repo rate	Policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework.
FACT: Standing Deposit Facility	Uncollateralised facility for RBI to absorb liquidity.
FACT: MSF	Overnight emergency borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities.
FACT: CRR	Share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI.
FACT: OMO	Outright RBI purchase or sale of government securities to alter durable liquidity.

3. Detailed transmission

1. The MPC changes the repo rate and communicates its inflation-growth assessment.
2. RBI liquidity operations keep the weighted average call rate aligned with the operating framework.
3. Money-market rates influence bank deposit costs, bond yields and external benchmark-linked lending rates.
4. Borrowing costs, credit availability, asset prices and expectations alter consumption and investment.
5. Aggregate demand and inflation respond with lags that depend on banking health, competition and fiscal conditions.

Deeper analytical layers

- ANALYSIS: Separate stance, policy rate, operating target, liquidity corridor and instruments; they form one architecture but do different jobs.
- ANALYSIS: The formal target concerns headline CPI, the repo is the MPC's policy signal and WACR is the operating target; treating any one as a synonym for the others obscures transmission.
- ANALYSIS: Transmission channels include interest rates, bank credit, asset prices, exchange rates and expectations.
- ANALYSIS: A liquidity deficit can keep overnight rates firm even when the announced stance is accommodative.
- ANALYSIS: Variable-rate operations can fine-tune transient liquidity while OMOs address durable conditions.
- ANALYSIS: Fiscal cash balances, currency leakage, capital flows and government spending create autonomous liquidity movements.
- ANALYSIS: RBI's balance-sheet actions can influence both rupee liquidity and foreign-exchange conditions.

4. Institutional architecture

- FACT: **Monetary Policy Committee**: decides the policy repo rate under the inflation-targeting framework.
- FACT: **RBI Financial Markets Operations Department**: conducts liquidity operations and market interventions.
- FACT: **Scheduled commercial banks and primary dealers**: transmit policy through money, credit and government-securities markets.

- **FACT: Government cash-management system:** changes autonomous liquidity through taxes, spending and balances with RBI.

5. Indian applications and boundary cases

- **ANALYSIS:** An OMO purchase injects durable liquidity by buying government securities outright.
- **ANALYSIS:** A repo supplies collateralised liquidity for a defined tenor; it is not an outright security purchase.
- **ANALYSIS:** A bank with expensive deposits or weak capital may cut lending rates less than the repo-rate reduction.

6. Limitations and trade-offs

- **ANALYSIS:** Rapid easing supports demand but can weaken inflation or exchange-rate confidence if conditions are not durable.
- **ANALYSIS:** Persistent surplus liquidity can dilute the policy signal and encourage leverage.
- **ANALYSIS:** Sterilising capital flows controls domestic liquidity but carries balance-sheet and market costs.
- **ANALYSIS:** Strong transmission aids policy effectiveness but exposes weak borrowers faster to tightening.
- **ANALYSIS:** Central-bank independence must coexist with transparency, accountability and fiscal-monetary coordination.

ANALYSIS: Boundary condition: A rate change cannot directly create food supply, repair a stalled project or recapitalise a weak borrower.

7. Must-Know Facts for Advanced Prelims

- **FACT:** RBI is the monetary authority, currency issuer, banker to government and banks, reserve manager and financial regulator within statutory mandates.
- **FACT:** The Monetary Policy Committee decides the policy repo rate; liquidity operations support transmission around the operating target.
- **FACT:** WACR is the operating target of the liquidity-management framework.
- **FACT:** A repo injects liquidity against collateral; reverse-style absorption removes liquidity.
- **FACT:** CRR changes affect lendable resources broadly, while OMO changes durable system liquidity through securities transactions.
- **FACT:** Monetary policy works with lags and cannot directly remove sector-specific supply bottlenecks.

8. Advanced Prelims traps

- **WRONG:** Every liquidity injection is a rate cut. -> Liquidity quantity and the policy-rate stance are distinct.
- **WRONG:** OMO and repo are identical. -> OMO is an outright transaction; repo is collateralised with repurchase.
- **WRONG:** NBFCs generally access LAF like scheduled banks. -> Direct access is institution- and facility-specific; the 2024 PYQ rejected the broad claim.
- **WRONG:** Currency notes are RBI income. -> Notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet.
- **WRONG:** A lower repo guarantees equal lending-rate cuts. -> Funding mix, deposits, risk and balance sheets affect pass-through.

9. CURRENT: Survey 2025-26 analytical application

Verified current anchor	Topic-specific analytical use
CURRENT: WACR averaged 8 basis points below the repo rate in FY26 up to 8 Jan 2026.	A WACR close to repo indicates effective overnight-rate alignment, though bank lending pass-through can still differ.
CURRENT: M3 showed 12.1% year-on-year growth in the Survey's FY26 liquidity snapshot.	Read broad-money growth beside credit, deposits and nominal activity rather than as an automatic inflation signal.
CURRENT: The Survey links repo easing, CRR changes and OMOs with improved market transmission.	Explain how rate action, reserve requirements and security purchases affect different parts of transmission.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: 2025 Prelims tested RBI income sources: government securities and foreign-currency operations.
- ANALYSIS: 2024 Prelims tested that NBFCs do not broadly enjoy direct LAF access.
- FACT: **2026 Prelims Q2 (official provisional key):** Hilton-Young Commission, fixed rupee-sterling rate, British remittances and external creditworthiness. Keep the provisional label; see ../README.md.

11. Mains-ready framework

Central thesis: Separate the policy-rate signal from liquidity implementation and then trace pass-through through markets, banks, borrowers and expectations.

1. Define **Repo rate** and distinguish it from **Standing Deposit Facility**.
2. RBI liquidity operations keep the weighted average call rate aligned with the operating framework.
3. Monetary Policy Committee: decides the policy repo rate under the inflation-targeting framework.
4. Rapid easing supports demand but can weaken inflation or exchange-rate confidence if conditions are not durable.
5. Recommend deep markets, competitive banking, clear communication and supply-side coordination.

12. Probable questions

- ANALYSIS: **Prelims:** Match repo, SDF, MSF, CRR and OMO with their liquidity effects and eligible counterparties.
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (10 marks):** Explain why liquidity management is necessary even after the MPC announces a repo-rate decision.
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** Evaluate the obstacles to complete monetary-policy transmission in India.

13. Study links

- FACT: Foundation companion: ../basic/04_RBI-Monetary-Policy-and-Liquidity-Management.md.
- FACT: 03_Inflation-Price-Indices-and-Business-Cycles.md - the objective and inflation diagnosis.
- FACT: 05_Banking-Structure-NBFCs-and-Financial-Regulation.md - institutions carrying transmission.
- FACT: 07_Money-Market-Capital-Market-and-Financial-Instruments.md - overnight rates and yield curves.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

RBI, Monetary Policy and Liquidity Management: RAPID MEASURE, INSTITUTION AND VINTAGE MAP

1. **Repo-rate signal:** The repo rate is the policy rate for collateralised liquidity from RBI under the operating framework; a repo-rate decision signals stance but is not identical to every liquidity injection.
2. **Standing Deposit Facility:** The SDF is an uncollateralised RBI facility for absorbing surplus liquidity and has served as the floor-side standing facility since its introduction in 2022.
3. **Marginal Standing Facility:** MSF is an overnight backstop borrowing window for scheduled commercial banks against eligible securities; its counterparty and emergency role differ from ordinary repo operations.
4. **Cash Reserve Ratio:** CRR is the share of net demand and time liabilities maintained as cash with RBI, broadly impounding bank resources and affecting lendable funds.
5. **Open Market Operations:** OMO purchases or sales are outright transactions in government securities that add or absorb durable liquidity and can influence yields beyond overnight cash conditions.
6. **WACR operating target:** The weighted average call rate is the operating target that RBI liquidity operations seek to align with the policy corridor; the policy target, repo rate and operating target are distinct.
7. **Monetary Policy Committee:** The six-member MPC consists of the RBI Governor, the monetary-policy Deputy Governor, one RBI-nominated officer and three external members appointed by the Central Government, and decides the policy repo rate.
8. **Flexible inflation targeting:** India's framework uses headline CPI as the nominal anchor with a 4 per cent target and a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points while considering growth.
9. **Statutory RBI status:** RBI is a statutory body under the RBI Act, not a constitutional body; the Governor is appointed by the Central Government and RBI performs monetary, currency, banking, reserve and payment functions.
10. **Transmission chain:** MPC communication and the repo signal influence money-market rates, bank funding and deposit rates, lending rates, bond yields, credit, demand, output and inflation with lags.
11. **SDF-liquidity distinction:** The 2022 SDF illustrates that RBI can absorb collateral-free surplus liquidity to align overnight rates without necessarily changing the repo-rate stance.
12. **Pandemic policy package:** During the pandemic RBI combined repo reductions with CRR easing, OMOs and targeted longer-term liquidity operations, showing that expansionary policy is an instrument package rather than a repo cut alone.
13. **Uneven pass-through:** Post-pandemic repo increases passed relatively quickly into external-benchmark-linked lending rates and more gradually into deposit rates and legacy loans because funding mix, competition and balance-sheet strength differ.
14. **Forex intervention and sterilisation:** RBI may sell or buy foreign exchange to smooth excessive rupee volatility and offset the domestic-liquidity effect through OMOs or absorption operations; sterilisation does not imply a fixed exchange-rate promise.
15. **OMO and yield conditions:** OMO affects durable liquidity and the government-securities yield curve, but its effect depends on market expectations, the fiscal borrowing environment and the broader monetary stance.
16. **Legal tender and RBI liabilities:** Legal tender must be accepted in settlement within the legal framework, and Indian currency notes issued are liabilities on RBI's balance sheet rather than RBI income.
17. **Money multiplier:** Reserve money supports broader money creation through banking; lower reserve impounding and currency leakage and greater willingness to lend generally raise the money multiplier.
18. **RBI income sources:** RBI income can arise from interest on government securities and foreign-currency assets, liquidity operations or lending to banks, and fees or commissions from banking and market functions.
19. **Payment-data direction:** RBI required payment-system data relating to systems operated in India to be stored in India for supervisory access; this is a regulated payments direction, not a universal data-localisation law.
20. **Committee-institution pairs:** The Hilton-Young Commission concerns colonial currency and central-banking reform, Narasimham Committees concern Government of India banking reform, and the Tarapore Committee

concerns RBI work on capital-account convertibility.

RBI, Monetary Policy and Liquidity Management: BASE-YEAR, BASKET, INSTRUMENT AND LEGAL-STATUS TRAPS

- Do not equate every liquidity injection with a repo-rate cut.
- Do not treat OMO and repo as identical; one is outright and the other is a repurchase transaction.
- Do not assume ordinary NBFCs have routine LAF access like scheduled banks.
- Do not call currency notes RBI income; notes issued are liabilities.
- Do not assume a lower repo guarantees equal lending-rate reductions.
- Do not merge the inflation target, tolerance band, repo rate and WACR operating target.
- Do not treat SDF as collateralised borrowing; it is uncollateralised absorption.
- Do not say CRR and OMO have the same mechanics or time horizon.
- Liquidity management aligns market rates with the operating framework; it is distinct from a fresh change in the monetary-policy stance.
- Do not claim monetary policy can directly repair food, energy or logistics shortages.
- Do not generalise a payment-system storage direction into a law for all data.
- Do not mismatch reform committees with their sponsoring institution or subject.

RBI, Monetary Policy and Liquidity Management: ANSWER-WRITING SPINE

DEFINE THE MEASURE OR INSTITUTION AND FIX ITS COVERAGE
-> STATE FORMULA, PRICE BASIS, BASE YEAR, BASKET OR LEGAL POWER
-> NAME THE PERIOD, ESTIMATE VINTAGE AND ISSUING BODY
-> TRACE THE TRANSMISSION OR ACCOUNTING RECONCILIATION
-> ADD ONE INDIA-SPECIFIC EVIDENCE UNIT AND ITS LIMIT
-> TEST DISTRIBUTION, OUTPUT, PRICE OR FINANCIAL-STABILITY EFFECTS
-> CONCLUDE WITH A GRADED VERDICT, NOT A TIMELESS NUMBER

RBI, Monetary Policy and Liquidity Management: LIVE-SOURCE AND ESTIMATE-STATUS BOUNDARY

The RBI Monetary Policy page was reachable only as raw HTML in this run. No current repo rate, stance, reserve ratio, liquidity amount or meeting outcome was extracted; the package relies on the audited owners for stable instrument mechanics and preserves every counterparty and legal distinction.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/12: Policy signal versus implementation

MPC -> repo-rate signal
RBI OPERATIONS -> liquidity alignment
WACR -> operating target
TRAP -> stance and quantity are distinct
MUST REMEMBER: RBI monetary policy works through the policy rate, liquidity framework,...

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/12: Liquidity corridor

MSF -> overnight backstop
REPO -> collateralised injection
WACR -> market operating rate
SDF -> uncollateralised absorption

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/12: CRR versus OMO

CRR -> reserve impounding ratio
OMO -> outright G-sec transaction
CRR -> broad bank-resource effect
OMO -> durable liquidity + yield effect

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/12: MPC institution map

RBI GOVERNOR
MONETARY-POLICY DEPUTY GOVERNOR
ONE RBI OFFICER + THREE EXTERNAL MEMBERS
SIX MEMBERS -> repo decision

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/12: Inflation target frame

NOMINAL ANCHOR -> headline CPI
TARGET -> 4 per cent
TOLERANCE -> plus/minus 2 percentage points
MANDATE -> price stability while mindful of growth

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/12: Transmission chain

REPO + COMMUNICATION
-> WACR + funding + deposit rates
-> lending rates + credit + demand
-> output and inflation with lags
CLOSE DISTINCTION: Repo policy rate is not every liquidity operation, liquidity surplus...

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/12: Pandemic package

REPO REDUCTIONS
CRR EASING
OMO PURCHASES
TARGETED LONGER-TERM LIQUIDITY

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/12: Pass-through frictions

EBLR LOANS -> faster response
DEPOSITS / LEGACY LOANS -> slower response
FRICTIONS -> funding + competition + risk
RESULT -> uneven burden

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/12: Forex-liquidity bridge

FOREX INTERVENTION
-> domestic liquidity changes
-> OMO / absorption offset
LIMIT -> volatility smoothing, not a fixed rate

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/12: Money multiplier

RESERVE MONEY
-> bank deposits and lending
LOWER CRR / LEAKAGE -> higher potential multiplier
LIMIT -> banks may hold reserves or avoid risk

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/12: RBI balance-sheet traps

NOTES ISSUED -> liability
G-SEC / FX INTEREST -> income source
PAYMENT STORAGE -> supervisory direction
COMMITTEES -> match sponsor and subject

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/12: Monetary-policy answer spine

DIAGNOSE inflation and output
STATE MPC signal
MAP liquidity implementation
TEST transmission, growth and external limits
EVIDENCE LIMIT: FORMULA / STATUS / CAUSATION: Preserve RBI Act, MPC, operating target and...